“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 1

The Supreme Principle of the Guru

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The chapter opens with fourteen verses that establish the truth (*tattva*). In verses 15–17 the author offers the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the auspicious invocation, glorifying Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Govinda and Śrī Gopīnātha. The first of the fourteen verses is a general obeisance to six truths, and the whole chapter is nothing but its detailed explanation. The word “guru” means both the *dīkṣā-guru*, who gives initiation, and the *śikṣā-guru*, who instructs. The disciple must regard them as a manifestation (*prakāśa*) of Kṛṣṇa. The Lord's devotees (*īśa-bhaktas*) are of two kinds: *siddhas*, who have reached perfection, and *sādhakas*, who are still on the path of practice (*sādhana*). The Lord (*Īśa*) is Kṛṣṇa in His original form, His *svayaṁ-rūpa*, together with His *kāya-vyūhas*, the expansions of His body. The avatāras are of three kinds: *aṁśa-avatāras*, *guṇa-avatāras* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*. In this connection the chapter examines the truth of Kṛṣṇa's *prakāśa*, and with it the truth of *vilāsa*. Kṛṣṇa has three kinds of potency (*śakti*): the Lakṣmīs in Vaikuṇṭha and other abodes, the queens in Dvārakā, and, best of all, the gopīs of Vraja. Kṛṣṇa and His *kāya-vyūhas* are *īśa-tattva*, the truth of the Lord. All the devotees are *āvaraṇa-tattva*, His surrounding retinue, and are therefore a special potency of His. A potency and its possessor are eternally one when they are seen as non-different, and eternally distinct when the potency is seen apart from its possessor. Thus His inconceivable potency establishes one undivided Truth. This conclusion agrees with Vedānta, and its name is *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, the truth of inconceivable oneness and difference. The last part of the chapter tells of the true nature (*svarūpa*) and greatness of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda.

Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda, Advaita — the root of *prema* — Haridāsa, Svarūpa Gosvāmī, Śrī Vaṁśīvadanānanda, Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda, the two brothers Rūpa and Sanātana; Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, Raghunātha — Dāsa and Bhaṭṭa, Śivānanda, Kavi Karṇapūra, Narottama, Śrīnivāsa, Rāmacandra, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Baladeva, and Cakravartī, the foremost. I have bowed with care to the Lord and His devotees, and in the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, which gives the essence, I have explained the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* at length. O devotees, weigh it well! The stories of Gaura are an ocean; Kṛṣṇadāsa sailed upon it and brought back a stream of nectar. Vaiṣṇavas drink the nectar of this poem, their hearts grow peaceful, and they long to drink it again and again. Everyone told me, poor and destitute as I am, to compose a commentary on it. I took the sādhus' command upon my head, composed this commentary with care, and placed it in the sādhus' hands.

*The auspicious invocation begins. General obeisance to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya as the Truth (*tattva*) —*

বন্দে গুরূনীশভক্তানীশমীশাবতারকান্ ।
তৎপ্রকাশাংশ্চ তচ্চক্তীঃ কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যসংজ্ঞকম্ ॥ ১ ॥

vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān
I worship the gurus the Lord's devotees
īśam īśāvatārakān
the Lord the Lord's avatāras
tat-prakāśāṁś ca tac-caktīḥ
His manifestations and His potencies
kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam
Kṛṣṇa Caitanya known as

1 I worship the gurus, the devotees of the Lord, the Lord’s avatāras, His manifestations and His potencies, and the Lord Himself, who is known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Special obeisance to the two worshipful Lords: Nitāi and Gaura rise together like the moon and the sun and show mercy to living beings —

বন্দে শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যনিত্যানন্দৌ সহোদিতৌ ।
গৌড়োদয়ে পুষ্পবন্তৌ চিত্রৌ শন্দৌ তমোনুদৌ ॥ ২ ॥

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
nityānandau sahoditau
(and) Nityānanda risen together
gauḍodaye puṣpavantau
on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa the sun and the moon
citrau śan-dau tamo-nudau
wondrous bestowing auspiciousness dispelling darkness

2 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda, who have risen together like the sun and the moon on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa. Wondrous and bestowing auspiciousness, They dispel the darkness.

The Truth this book establishes. The one nondual Supreme Truth, Gaura-Kṛṣṇa, is perceived in three different ways —

যদদ্বৈতং ব্রহ্মোপনিষদি তদপ্যস্য তনুভা
য আত্মান্তর্য্যামী পুরুষ ইতি সোঽস্যাংশবিভবঃ ৷
ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যৈঃ পূর্ণো য ইহ ভগবান্ স স্বয়ময়ং
ন চৈতন্যাৎ কৃষ্ণাজ্জগতি পরতত্ত্বং পরমিহ ॥ ৩ ॥

yad advaitaṁ brahmopaniṣadi tad apy asya tanu-bhā
that which non-dual Brahman in the Upaniṣads that too His the radiance of the body
ya ātmāntaryāmī puruṣa iti so 'syāṁśa-vibhavaḥ
who the Self dwelling within the Puruṣa thus (called) he His plenary expansion
ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ pūrṇo ya iha bhagavān sa svayam ayaṁ
with the six opulences full who here Bhagavān He Himself this one
na caitanyāt kṛṣṇāj jagati para-tattvaṁ param iha
not than Caitanya Kṛṣṇa in the world Supreme Truth higher here

3 What the Upaniṣads call the non-dual Brahman is only the radiance of His body. The one called the Puruṣa, the Supersoul dwelling within all, is His plenary expansion. And Bhagavān, full of the six opulences, is He Himself. In this world there is no Supreme Truth higher than Caitanya, who is Kṛṣṇa.

*The blessing, and the external reason for Gaura's descent — (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 2)*

অনর্পিতচরীং চিরাৎ করুণয়াবতীর্ণঃ কলৌ
সমর্পয়িতুমুন্নতোজ্জ্বলরসাং স্বভক্তিশ্রিয়ম্ ।
হরিঃ পুরটসুন্দরদ্যুতিকদম্বসন্দীপিতঃ
সদা হৃদয়কন্দরে স্ফুরতু বঃ শচীনন্দনঃ ॥ ৪ ॥

anarpita-carīṁ cirāt karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau
not given before for a long time out of mercy descended in the age of Kali
samarpayitum unnatojjvala-rasāṁ sva-bhakti-śriyam
to bestow most exalted radiant rasa the treasure of devotion to Himself
hariḥ puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ
Hari than gold more beautiful of radiance by a mass illumined
sadā hṛdaya-kandare sphuratu vaḥ śacī-nandanaḥ
always in the cave of the heart may He shine your the son of Śacī

4 “Out of mercy He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a long time: the treasure of devotion to Himself, rich in the most exalted and radiant *rasa* of divine love. May that Lord Hari, the son of Śacī, resplendent with a mass of radiance more beautiful than gold, ever shine in the cave of your heart.” (Vidagdha-mādhava 1.2)

The root purpose of Gaura's descent; the truth about Gaura — (from the diary of Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

রাধা কৃষ্ণপ্রণয়বিকৃতির্হ্লাদিনীশক্তিরস্মা-
দেকাত্মানাবপি ভুবি পুরা দেহভেদং গতৌ তৌ ।
চৈতন্যাখ্যং প্রকটমধুনা তদ্দ্বয়ং চৈক্যমাপ্তং
রাধাভাবদ্যুতিসুবলিতং নৌমি কৃষ্ণস্বরূপম্ ॥ ৫ ॥

rādhā kṛṣṇa-praṇaya-vikṛtir hlādinī śaktir asmād
Rādhā of love for Kṛṣṇa the transformation pleasure-giving potency therefore
ekātmānāv api bhuvi purā deha-bhedaṁ gatau tau
one in soul although on earth long ago separate bodies assumed They two
caitanyākhyaṁ prakaṭam adhunā tad-dvayaṁ caikyam āptaṁ
called Caitanya manifest now those two and oneness attained
rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalitaṁ naumi kṛṣṇa-svarūpam
with Rādhā's emotion and radiance adorned I bow to Kṛṣṇa Himself

5 "Rādhā is the transformation of love for Kṛṣṇa; She is His pleasure-giving potency (*hlādinī śakti*). Therefore, although Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in soul, long ago They assumed separate forms on earth. Now the two have become one and appeared as Caitanya. I bow to Him, who is Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with Rādhā's emotion and radiance." (Svarūpa Dāmodara's diary)

The root purpose of Gaura's descent: three confidential reasons —

শ্রীরাধায়াঃ প্রণয়মহিমা কীদৃশো বানয়ৈবা-
স্বাদ্যো যেনাদ্ভুতমধুরিমা কীদৃশো বা মদীয়ঃ ।
সৌখ্যঞ্চাস্যা মদনুভবতঃ কীদৃশং বেতি লোভা-
ত্তদ্ভাবাঢ্যঃ সমজনি শচীগর্ভসিন্ধৌ হরীন্দুঃ ॥ ৬ ॥

śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-mahimā kīdṛśo vānayaivā-
of Śrī Rādhā of love the greatness of what kind or by Her alone
svādyo yenādbhuta-madhurimā kīdṛśo vā madīyaḥ
relished by which (love) wondrous sweetness of what kind or Mine
saukhyaṁ cāsyā mad-anubhavataḥ kīdṛśaṁ veti lobhāt
the happiness and Her from realizing Me of what kind or thus out of longing
tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ samajani śacī-garbha-sindhau harīnduḥ
rich with Her emotion was born in the ocean of Śacī's womb the moon Hari

6 "How great is Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My own wondrous sweetness, which She alone relishes through that love? And what happiness does She

feel when She realizes Me?" Longing to know this, the moon Hari, rich with Her emotion, was born from the ocean of Śacī's womb.

The truth about Śrī Nityānanda, and obeisance to Him —

সঙ্কর্ষণঃ কারণতোয়শায়ী
গর্ভোদশায়ী চ পয়োঽব্ধিশায়ী ।
শেষশ্চ যস্যাংশকলাঃ স নিত্যা-
নন্দাখ্যরামঃ শরণং মমাস্তু ॥ ৭ ॥

saṅkarṣaṇaḥ kāraṇa-toya-śāyī
Saṅkarṣaṇa lying in the Causal Ocean
garbhoda-śāyī ca payo'bdhi-śāyī
lying in the Garbha Ocean and lying in the Ocean of Milk
śeṣaś ca yasyāṁśa-kalāḥ sa nityā-
Śeṣa and whose portions and parts He Nityā-
nandākhya-rāmaḥ śaraṇaṁ mamāstu
-nanda called Rāma shelter my may be

7 Saṅkarṣaṇa, Kāraṇodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī, Kṣīrodakaśāyī and Śeṣa are His portions and the parts of His portions. May that Rāma who is called Nityānanda be my shelter.

The five forms of Śrī Nityānanda. (1) His form as Saṅkarṣaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha —

মায়াতীতে ব্যাপিবৈকুণ্ঠলোকে
পূর্ণৈশ্বর্য্যে শ্রীচতুর্ব্যূহমধ্যে ।
রূপং যস্যোদ্ভাতি সঙ্কর্ষণাখ্যং
তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ৮ ॥

māyātīte vyāpi-vaikuṇṭha-loke
beyond māyā in the all-pervading realm of Vaikuṇṭha
pūrṇaiśvarye śrī-catur-vyūha-madhye
full of opulence among the divine four vyūhas
rūpaṁ yasyodbhāti saṅkarṣaṇākhyaṁ
the form whose shines forth called Saṅkarṣaṇa
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

8 Beyond māyā lies the all-pervading realm of Vaikuṇṭha, full of every opulence. There, among the four divine vyūhas, His form called Saṅkarṣaṇa shines forth. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma.

(2) The Supersoul, the cause of living beings and the world —
Kāraṇodakaśāyī, the first Puruṣa —

মায়াভর্ত্তাজাণ্ডসঙ্ঘাশ্রয়াঙ্গঃ
শেতে সাক্ষাৎ কারণাম্ভোধিমধ্যে ৷
যস্যৈকাংশঃ শ্রীপুমানদিদেব-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ৯ ॥

māyā-bhartājāṇḍa-saṅghāśrayāṅgaḥ
the master of māyā whose body shelters the multitude of universes
śete sākṣāt kāraṇāmbhodhi-madhye
lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean
yasyaikāṁśaḥ śrī-pumān ādi-devas
whose one portion the blessed Puruṣa the original Lord
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

9 The blessed Puruṣa, the original Lord and the master of māyā, whose body shelters countless universes, lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean. He is one portion of Nityānanda. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma.

(3) The father of the lotus-born — Garbhodakaśāyī, the second Puruṣa —

যস্যাংশাংশঃ শ্রীল-গর্ভোদশায়ী
যন্নাভ্যব্জং লোকসঙ্ঘাতনালম্ ।
লোকস্রষ্টুঃ সূতিকাধামধাতু-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ১০ ॥

yasyāṁśāṁśaḥ śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī
whose portion of a portion the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī
yan-nābhy-abjaṁ loka-saṅghāta-nālam
from whose navel the lotus of the multitude of worlds the stem
loka-sraṣṭuḥ sūtikā-dhāma dhātus
of the creator of the worlds the birthplace of Brahmā
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

10 "The blessed Garbhodakaśāyī is a portion of His portion. The lotus from His navel has a stem that holds the multitude of worlds, and it is the birthplace of Brahmā, the creator of the worlds. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma."

(4) Kṣīrodaśāyī, the third Puruṣa; (5) Śeṣa, who holds up the earth —

যস্যাংশাংশাংশঃ পরাত্মাখিলানাং
পোষ্টা বিষ্ণুর্ভাতি দুগ্ধাব্ধিশায়ী ।
ক্ষৌণীভর্ত্তা যৎকলা সোঽপ্যনন্ত-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ১১ ॥

yasyāṁśāṁśāṁśaḥ parātmākhilānāṁ
whose portion of a portion of a portion the Supersoul of all beings
poṣṭā viṣṇur bhāti dugdhābdhi-śāyī
the maintainer Viṣṇu shines lying in the Ocean of Milk
kṣauṇī-bhartā yat-kalā so 'py anantas
the upholder of the earth whose part he also Ananta
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

11 “Viṣṇu who lies in the Ocean of Milk, the Supersoul and maintainer of all beings, is a portion of a portion of His portion. Ananta, who upholds the earth, is also His part. I surrender to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma.”

The truth about Śrī Advaita, and obeisance to Him —

মহাবিষ্ণুর্জগৎকর্ত্তা মায়য়া যঃ সৃজত্যদঃ ৷
তস্যাবতার এবায়মদ্বৈতাচার্য্য ঈশ্বরঃ ॥ ১২ ॥

mahā-viṣṇur jagat-kartā
Mahā-Viṣṇu the creator of the world
māyayā yaḥ sṛjaty adaḥ
through māyā who creates this (world)
tasyāvatāra evāyam
His avatāra indeed this
advaitācārya īśvaraḥ
Advaita Ācārya the Lord

12 Mahā-Viṣṇu, the creator of the world, creates this universe through His energy, māyā. The Lord Advaita Ācārya is His very avatāra.

অদ্বৈতং হরিণাদ্বৈতাদচার্য্যং ভক্তিশংসনাৎ ৷
ভক্তাবতারমীশং তমদ্বৈতাচার্য্যমাশ্রয়ে ॥ ১৩ ॥

advaitaṁ hariṇādvaitād
(called) Advaita being non-different from Hari
ācāryaṁ bhakti-śaṁsanāt
(called) Ācārya for proclaiming bhakti
bhaktāvatāram īśaṁ tam
the avatāra as a devotee the Lord Him
advaitācāryam āśraye
Advaita Ācārya I take shelter of

13 He is called Advaita because He is non-different from Hari, and Ācārya because He proclaims devotion (*bhakti*). I take shelter of that Lord, Advaita Ācārya, who descended as a devotee.

*The intrinsic nature (*svarūpa*) of the Pañca-tattva, and obeisance to Them —*

পঞ্চতত্ত্বাত্মকং কৃষ্ণং ভক্তরূপস্বরূপকম্ ।
ভক্তাবতারং ভক্তাখ্যং নমামি ভক্তশক্তিকম্ ॥ ১৪ ॥

pañca-tattvātmakaṁ kṛṣṇaṁ
comprising the five truths Kṛṣṇa
bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam
in the form of a devotee in the identity of a devotee
bhaktāvatāraṁ bhaktākhyaṁ
the avatāra as a devotee the one called a devotee
namāmi bhakta-śaktikam
I bow to the devotional potency

14 "I bow to Kṛṣṇa, who comprises the five truths (Pañca-tattva). He appears in the form of a devotee, in the identity of a devotee, as the avatāra of a devotee, as the one called a devotee, and as the devotional potency."

Anubhāṣya.
At the very beginning the author wrote fourteen verses as the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the auspicious invocation. In them he pointed out the subject this book establishes, blessed the listeners and offered them his respects. The first seven chapters of the Ādi-līlā explain exactly this, step by step and in detail.

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *sambandha* (relationship with the Lord) —*

জয়তাং সুরতৌ পঙ্গোর্মম মন্দমতের্গতী ।
মৎসর্ব্বস্বপদাম্ভোজৌ রাধামদনমোহনৌ ॥ ১৫ ॥

jayatāṁ suratau paṅgor
all glory to the most merciful of the lame
mama manda-mater gatī
my of little intelligence the refuge
mat-sarvasva-padāmbhojau
whose lotus feet are my all in all
rādhā-madana-mohanau
Rādhā and Madana-mohana

15 All glory to the most merciful Rādhā and Madana-mohana! They are the refuge of me, who am lame and of little intelligence, and Their lotus feet are my all in all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I am lame and dull-witted. My only refuge is the supremely merciful Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Madana-mohana, and Their lotus feet are all my wealth. May They be glorified!

Anubhāṣya.

Verses composed by the author himself —

paṅgoḥ (of one who cannot go elsewhere on his own feet, by his own strength) **manda-mateḥ** (of one whose small intelligence is absorbed in sense objects; of one who makes no effort in practices driven by other desires, karma, jñāna and the like; of one devoted exclusively [*ekāntin*]) **mama gatī** (my refuge: such are They for me. *Gati* is "that toward which one goes" [*gamyate*], that is, a shelter) **mat-sarvasva-padāmbhojau** (They whose lotus feet are all my wealth) **suratau** (merciful; or, boundlessly attached to each other) **rādhā-madana-mohanau** (the Deities who bear these names) **jayatām** (may They abide in all Their supremacy).

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *abhidheya* (the means) —*

দীব্যদ্বৃন্দারণ্যকল্পদ্রুমাধঃ-
শ্রীমদ্রত্নাগারসিংহাসনস্থৌ ।
শ্রীশ্রীরাধা-শ্রীলগোবিন্দদেবৌ
প্রেষ্ঠালীভিঃ সেব্যমানৌ স্মরামি ॥ ১৬ ॥

dīvyad-vṛndāraṇya-kalpa-drumādhaḥ-
resplendent in the forest of Vṛndāvana a wish-fulfilling tree beneath
śrīmad-ratnāgāra-siṁhāsana-sthau
in a splendid jewelled temple on a throne seated
śrī śrī rādhā-śrīla-govinda-devau
Śrī Śrī Rādhā Śrīla Govinda-deva
preṣṭhālībhiḥ sevyamānau smarāmi
by Their dearest companions being served I remember

16 In resplendent Vṛndāvana, beneath a wish-fulfilling tree, Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrīla Govinda-deva sit on a throne in a splendid jewelled temple, and Their dearest companions serve Them. I remember Them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Govinda sit on a throne in a jewelled temple, beneath the wish-fulfilling tree of Vṛndāvana, a land of radiant beauty. Their dear companions serve Them. I remember Them.

Anubhāṣya.

dīvyad-vṛndāraṇya-kalpa-drumādhaḥ (at the foot of the wish-fulfilling tree in the radiant forest of Vṛndāvana. "Radiant" means supremely beautiful and enchanting to the mind) **śrīmad-ratnāgāra-siṁhāsana-sthau** (seated on a jewelled throne within a jewelled chamber of wondrous beauty) **preṣṭhālībhiḥ** (by Their dearest companions, devoted to service: the intimate confidantes [*priya-narma-sakhīs*] led by Śrī Lalitā, who are surrounded by Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī and others) **sevyamānau** (Those whom they serve) **śrī-śrī-rādhā-śrīla-govinda-devau smarāmi** (I remember Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrīla Govindadeva).

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *prayojana* (the goal) —*

श्रीमान् रासरसारम्भी वंशीवटतटस्थितः ।
कर्षन् वेणुस्वनैर्गोपीर्गोपीनाथः श्रियेऽस्तु नः ॥ १७ ॥

śrīmān rāsa-rasārambhī
the beautiful who began the rasa of the rāsa dance
vaṁśīvaṭa-taṭa-sthitaḥ
at Vaṁśīvaṭa on the bank standing
karṣan veṇu-svanair gopīr
attracting with the sounds of His flute the gopīs
gopī-nāthaḥ śriye 'stu naḥ
Gopīnātha for the welfare may He be our

17 Beautiful Śrī Gopīnātha began the sweet *rasa* of the rāsa dance. He stands on the riverbank at Vaṁśīvaṭa and draws the gopīs with the sound of His flute. May He bestow His blessings upon us.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrīmān Gopīnātha, who begins the rapturous *rāsa* dance, stands on the bank by Vaṁśīvaṭa and draws the gopīs with the sound of His flute. May He grant us what is auspicious.

Anubhāṣya.

śrīmān (He whose form is full of supreme beauty) **rāsa-rasārambhī** (He who begins the rapturous *rāsa* dance) **veṇu-svanaiḥ** (with the sounds of His flute) **gopīḥ** (the gopīs, the young cowherd women of Vraja) **karṣan** (drawing. He loosens in them every desire unrelated to Kṛṣṇa and, by the rope of *prema* that is His flute's sound, draws them out of their homes) **vaṁśīvaṭa-taṭa-sthitaḥ** (standing at the foot of the Vaṁśīvaṭa tree) **gopī-nāthaḥ** (He who sports freely) **naḥ** (for us) **śriye** (for the wealth of *prema*) **astu** (may He be).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ১৮ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaita-candra glory to Gaura's devotees host

18 All glory, all glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaita-candra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

The three Deities whom the Gauḍīyas long to worship —

এই তিন ঠাকুর গৌড়ীয়াকে করিয়াছেন আত্মসাৎ ।
এ তিনের চরণ বন্দোঁ, তিনে মোর নাথ ॥ ১৯ ॥

ei tina ṭhākura gauḍīyāke kariyāchena ātmasāt
these three Deities the Gauḍīyas have made Their own
e tinera caraṇa vandoṅ, tine mora nātha
these three's feet I worship the three my masters

19 These three Deities have made the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas Their own. I worship the feet of these three, for these three are my masters.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

These three Deities — Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Govindadeva and Śrī Gopīnātha — are the presiding Lords of Vṛndāvana. They gave the Gauḍīya devotees the right to serve each of Them, and so made them Their own.

Anubhāṣya.

The Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas serve the eighteen-syllable mantra. The Kṛṣṇa named in it is Madana-mohana; its Govinda is Govinda; and its Gopījana-vallabha is Gopīnātha. To realize Kṛṣṇa as Madana-mohana is *sambandha*. To serve Govinda is *abhidheya*. To be drawn by Gopījana-vallabha is *prayojana*. Śrī Mahāprabhu taught these three truths: *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*. These three Deities are forms of Bhagavān that embody those three truths, and They are the presiding Lords of Śrī Vṛndāvana.

The word *gauḍīya* means “of the land of Gauḍa.” The part of Bhārata-varṣa south of the Himālayas and north of the Vindhyas is called Āryāvarta. It holds the five lands of Gauḍa: Sārasvata, Kānyakubja (Lakṣmaṇāvatī), Madhya-gauḍa, Maithila and Utkala. Many call Bengal Gauḍa, and the name “Gauḍa” belonged above all to the capital of Bengal. Devotees from Utkala are called “Oriya devotees,” and in the same way the people of Bengal are called “Gauḍīya.” The south, in turn, is known as Pañca-draviḍa, “the five Draviḍas.” All four ācāryas of the Vaiṣṇava sampradāyas were born in the land of Draviḍa. The Draviḍian Vaiṣṇavas took shelter of these ācāryas. So the word “Gauḍīya” may well have come into use from a wish to be distinguished from them. Śrī Rāmānujācārya was born at Mahābhūtapurī in southern Andhra; Śrī Madhvācārya in the village of Uḍupī in Paraśurāma-kṣetra, in the Mangalore district; Śrī Nimbāditya in the village of Muṅgerapattana in Dakṣiṇāpatha; and Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī in the land of Pāṇḍya. Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted the Śrī Mādhva-sampradāya. Yet the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas of the Tattvavāda branch, who hold to Madhva's teaching, are Draviḍians. Therefore the sampradāya that has taken shelter at Śrī Gaura's feet is called “Gauḍīya.” Moreover, Śrī Ānandatīrtha Pūrṇaprajña Madhvācārya has another name: Śrī Gauḍa-pūrṇānanda. So Śrī Gaura's devotees may be called “Mādhva” as well as “Gauḍīya.”

The author explains his own auspicious invocation —

গ্রন্থের আরম্ভে করি মঙ্গলাচরণ ।
গুরু, বৈষ্ণব, ভগবান্ — তিনের স্মরণ ॥ ২০ ॥

granthera ārambhe kari maṅgalācaraṇa
of the book at the beginning I make the invocation
guru, vaiṣṇava, bhagavān — tinera smaraṇa
guru Vaiṣṇava Bhagavān of the three remembrance

20 At the beginning of this book I offer the auspicious invocation (*maṅgalācaraṇa*) by remembering three: the guru, the Vaiṣṇavas and the Lord.

তিনের স্মরণে হয় বিঘ্নবিনাশন ।
অনায়াসে হয় নিজ বাঞ্ছিতপূরণ ॥ ২১ ॥

tinera smaraṇe haya vighna-vināśana
of the three in remembering there is destruction of obstacles
anāyāse haya nija vāñcita-pūraṇa
easily there is one's own fulfilment of desires

21 Remembering these three destroys every obstacle, and one’s own desires are easily fulfilled.

সে মঙ্গলাচরণ হয় ত্রিবিধ প্রকার ।
বস্তুনির্দ্দেশ, আশীর্ব্বাদ, নমস্কার ॥ ২২ ॥

se maṅgalācaraṇa haya tri-vidha prakāra
that invocation is threefold in kind
vastu-nirdeśa, āśīrvāda, namaskāra
defining the subject blessing obeisance

22 That invocation is of three kinds: defining the subject, giving a blessing and offering obeisances.

প্রথম দুই শ্লোকে ইষ্টদেব-নমস্কার ।
সামান্য-বিশেষ-রূপে দুই ত’ প্রকার ॥ ২৩ ॥

prathama dui śloke iṣṭa-deva-namaskāra
in the first two verses obeisance to the worshipful Lord
sāmānya-viśeṣa-rūpe dui ta' prakāra
general and particular in form two indeed kinds

23 In the first two verses I offer obeisances to the worshipful Lord. These are of two kinds: general and particular.

তৃতীয় শ্লোকেতে করি বস্তুর নির্দ্দেশ ।
যাহা হৈতে জানি পরতত্ত্বের উদ্দেশ ॥ ২৪ ॥

tṛtīya śloke kari vastura nirdeśa
in the third verse I make of the subject the definition
yāhā haite jāni para-tattvera uddeśa
which from one knows of the Supreme Truth the identity

24 In the third verse I define the subject, and from it one can know the identity of the Supreme Truth.

চতুর্থ শ্লোকেতে করি জগতে আশীর্ব্বাদ ।
সর্ব্বত্র মাগিয়ে কৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-প্রসাদ ॥ ২৫ ॥

caturtha śloke kari jagate āśīrvāda
in the fourth verse I make to the world blessing
sarvatra māgiye kṛṣṇa-caitanya-prasāda
everywhere I pray for Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's mercy

25 In the fourth verse I bless the world, praying that the mercy of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya may reach everywhere.

সেই শ্লোকে কহি বাহ্যাবতার-কারণ ।
পঞ্চ ষষ্ঠ শ্লোকে কহি মূল-প্রয়োজন ॥ ২৬ ॥

sei śloke kahi bāhyāvatāra-kāraṇa
in that verse I tell the external reason for the descent
pañca ṣaṣṭha śloke kahi mūla-prayojana
in the fifth sixth verses I tell the root purpose

26 In that verse I also state the external reason for His descent. In the fifth and sixth verses I state its root purpose.

এই ছয় শ্লোকে কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যের তত্ত্ব ।
আর পঞ্চ শ্লোকে নিত্যানন্দের মহত্ত্ব ॥ ২৭ ॥

ei chaya śloke kṛṣṇa caitanyera tattva
in these six verses Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's truth
āra pañca śloke nityānandera mahattva
then in five verses Nityānanda's greatness

27 These six verses describe the truth of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. The next five verses describe the greatness of Nityānanda.

আর দুই শ্লোকে অদ্বৈত-তত্ত্বাখ্যান ।
আর এক শ্লোকে পঞ্চতত্ত্বের ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ২৮ ॥

āra dui śloke advaita-tattvākhyāna
then in two verses an account of Advaita's truth
āra eka śloke pañca-tattvera vyākhyāna
then in one verse of the Pañca-tattva the explanation

28 The next two verses give an account of the truth of Advaita, and one more verse explains the Pañca-tattva.

এই চৌদ্দশ্লোকে করি মঙ্গলাচরণ ।
তহিঁ মধ্যে কহি সব বস্তুনিরূপণ ॥ ২৯ ॥

ei caudda śloke kari maṅgalācaraṇa
in these fourteen verses I make the invocation
tahiṅ madhye kahi saba vastu-nirūpaṇa
that within I tell all the description of the subject

29 With these fourteen verses I offer the invocation, and within them I describe the whole subject.

সব শ্রোতা-বৈষ্ণবেরে করি' নমস্কার ।
এই সব শ্লোকের করি অর্থ-বিচার ॥ ৩০ ॥

saba śrotā-vaiṣṇavere kari' namaskāra
to all the listening Vaiṣṇavas having offered obeisances
ei saba ślokera kari artha-vicāra
of all these verses I make examination of the meaning

30 Offering obeisances to all the Vaiṣṇavas who are listening, I shall now examine the meaning of all these verses.

সকল বৈষ্ণব, শুন করি' একমন ।
চৈতন্য-কৃষ্ণের শাস্ত্র য়েমত নিরূপণ ॥ ৩১ ॥

sakala vaiṣṇava, śuna kari' eka-mana
all Vaiṣṇavas listen making one-pointed mind
caitanya-kṛṣṇera śāstra yemata-nirūpaṇa
of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa the scriptures as establish

31 O Vaiṣṇavas, all of you, listen with undivided attention to how the scriptures establish the truth of Caitanya, who is Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
What the scriptures establish about Kṛṣṇa, who appeared as Caitanya.

The explanation of the fourteen verses above begins. Explanation of the first verse —

কৃষ্ণ, গুরুদ্বয়, ভক্ত, অবতার, প্রকাশ ।
শক্তি, — এই ছয় রূপে করেন বিলাস ॥ ৩২ ॥

kṛṣṇa, gurudvaya, bhakta, avatāra, prakāśa
Kṛṣṇa the two kinds of guru devotees avatāras manifestations
śakti, — ei chaya rūpe karena vilāsa
potencies in these six forms He enjoys pastimes

32 The Lord enjoys His pastimes in six forms: as Kṛṣṇa Himself, as the two kinds of guru, as the devotees, as the avatāras, as His manifestations and as

His potencies.

Anubhāṣya.

The word *guru-dvaya* (“two gurus”) means the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*. Both are the one, undivided *guru-tattva*. The *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru* differ in their *līlās*, but for the disciple both are the same truth and deserve the same honour.

এই ছয় তত্ত্বের করি চরণ বন্দন ।
প্রথমে সামান্যে করি মঙ্গলাচরণ ॥ ৩৩ ॥

ei chaya tattvera kari caraṇa vandana
of these six truths I make to the feet worship
prathame sāmānye kari maṅgalācaraṇa
first in general I make the invocation

33 I worship the feet of these six truths. First I offer the invocation in a general way.

বন্দে গুরূনীশভক্তানীশমীশাবতারকান্ ।
তৎপ্রকাশাংশ্চ তচ্চক্তীঃ কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যসংজ্ঞকম্ ॥ ৩৪ ॥

vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān
I worship the gurus the Lord's devotees
īśam īśāvatārakān
the Lord the Lord's avatāras
tat-prakāśāṁś ca tac-caktīḥ
His manifestations and His potencies
kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam
Kṛṣṇa Caitanya known as

34 I worship the gurus, the devotees of the Lord, the Lord’s avatāras, His manifestations and His potencies, and the Lord Himself, who is known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship the two gurus, distinguished as the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*; the Lord's devotees, Śrīvāsa and others; the Lord's avatāras, Advaita Prabhu and

others; the Lord's manifestations, Prabhu Śrī Nityānanda and others; and the Lord's potencies, Śrī Gadādhara and others. And I worship the Supreme Truth, the Lord Himself, named Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

(**grantha-kāraḥ** (the author of the book, that is, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa)) **gurūn** (the host of gurus, that is, those who show the way, give the mantra and instruct: Śrī Nityānanda, Raghunātha, Rūpa and others) **īśa-bhaktān** (the servants of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa: Śrīvāsa and others) **kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam īśam** (Bhagavān, known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **īśāvatārakān** (Śrī Advaitācārya and others) **tat-prakāśān** (His manifestations, that is, those of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa: Śrī Nityānanda and others, my own gurus) **tac-chaktīḥ** (His potencies, that is, those of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa: Śrī Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Jagadānanda and others) (These six truths are non-different from Him and form His surrounding retinue, His *āvaraṇa*) **vande** ([I] worship).

*Gurus who differ in their *līlās* —*

মন্ত্রগুরু আর যত শিক্ষাগুরুগণ ।
তাঁহার চরণ আগে করিয়ে বন্দন ॥ ৩৫ ॥

mantra-guru āra yata śikṣā-guru-gaṇa
the initiating guru and all the instructing gurus
tāṅhāra caraṇa āge kariye vandana
their feet first I worship

35 First I worship the feet of my initiating guru and of all my instructing gurus.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Tāṅhāra (“his”): the singular is used because both kinds of guru are regarded as one truth. A variant reading has *tāṅ-sabāra* (“of them all”).

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 202): “The means to be followed (*abhidheya*) is selfless devotion, *akiñcanā bhakti*. Yet its cause is ‘association with My devotees,’ so that association is itself the means, and in devotion too one should see that very association. At first a person associates with particular devotees. That association gives rise to a corresponding faith, a taste for the narratives handed down in their line, and so on, and so he turns toward

Bhagavān. Through that same association a taste (*ruci*) awakens in him for the particular manifestation of Bhagavān whom those devotees worship, and for their particular path of worship. Then, wishing to know these more fully, he takes one or many of them as his guru and hears from them. * * For those who long for devotion marked by love (*prīti*), the path led by taste is better than the path of reasoning, which guides those in whom taste has not yet awakened. On both paths the former *śravaṇa-guru*, the guru from whom one hears, becomes the *śikṣā-guru* and teaches the rules of worship. But the *mantra-guru* is only one, for accepting many will be forbidden later." (Section 206): "The *śravaṇa-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru* who teaches worship are usually the same person. One should also know that there may be many *śikṣā-gurus*." (Section 208): "Knowledge of the scriptures arises only from association with the *śravaṇa-guru*." (Section 207): "Mercy (*anugraha*) means initiation into the mantra." (Section 209): "Those who reject the guru's feet and try to turn toward Bhagavān grow weary in their various means. Therefore hundreds of calamities befall them, and they remain here in worldly existence (*saṁsāra*), like those adrift on the ocean without a helmsman." "He is attained through devotion to the guru, and the wise serve Him by remembrance. But even when He is met, living beings absorbed in pride cannot attain Him." (Section 210): "One should take shelter of the guru who guides one to the highest goal, even if one must give up a worldly guru and others to do so."

If selfless devotion is the means, then what one should see in it is association with Kṛṣṇa's devotees. At first the *jīva* associates with Kṛṣṇa's devotees, gains faith (*śraddhā*) and turns toward Kṛṣṇa. Through that association a taste awakens in him for the particular manifestation of Bhagavān he will serve, and for a particular path of worship. A *jīva* endowed with pious merit (*sukṛti*) then wishes to know more about Kṛṣṇa. He takes shelter of one or more gurus and hears from them. For those who seek devotion marked by love, the path of taste is commended, not the path of reasoning followed by those in whom taste has not awakened. On both paths the former *śravaṇa-guru* becomes the *śikṣā-guru* and teaches the corresponding rules of worship. The *mantra-guru* is one; accepting many is forbidden. The *śravaṇa-guru* and the guru who teaches worship are usually the same person, while *śikṣā-gurus* may be many. And knowledge of the scriptures comes only from association with the *śravaṇa-guru*. Initiation into the mantra is itself the mercy (*anugraha*). Those who disregard the guru's lotus feet and seek nearness to Bhagavān grow weary in their various means. So hundreds upon hundreds of calamities fall upon the living being who lacks devotion to the guru.

He bears the name of a devotee, yet the calamities keep him only in worldly existence. Like a boat on the ocean without a helmsman, he finds no deliverance from it. Kṛṣṇa is attained only by serving the guru. Devotees serve Him by remembrance and other practices. Someone may think, “I already understand more — what more could another guru teach me?” Such pride is an offense, and because of it one cannot attain devotion to Kṛṣṇa. One should take shelter not of an unworthy pretender (*guru-bruva*) — a worldly, conventional or hereditary guru — but of the *pāramārthika-guru*, who guides one to the highest goal.

*The author's *śikṣā-gurus* —*

শ্রীরূপ, সনাতন, ভট্ট রঘুনাথ ।
শ্রীজীব, গোপালভট্ট, দাস রঘুনাথ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

śrī-rūpa, sanātana, bhaṭṭa raghunātha
Śrī Rūpa Sanātana Bhaṭṭa Raghunātha
śrī-jīva, gopāla-bhaṭṭa, dāsa raghunātha
Śrī Jīva Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Dāsa Raghunātha

36 Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Raghunātha Dāsa —

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana and Śrī Jīva — see Ādi 10.85. Śrī Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa — see Ādi 10.153–158. Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa — see Ādi 10.91. Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa — see Ādi 10.105.

এই ছয় গুরু — শিক্ষাগুরু যে আমার ।
তাঁ’ সবার পাদপদ্মে কোটি নমস্কার ॥ ৩৭ ॥

ei chaya guru — śikṣā-guru ye āmāra
these six gurus instructing gurus who mine
tāṅ’ sabāra pāda-padme koṭi namaskāra
their all at the lotus feet ten million obeisances

37 these six are my instructing gurus. I offer ten million obeisances at the lotus feet of them all.

*The Lord's devotee (*īśa-bhakta*) —*

ভগবানের ভক্ত যত শ্রীবাস প্রধান ।
তাঁহার চরণপদ্মে সহস্র প্রণাম ॥ ৩৮ ॥

bhagavānera bhakta yata śrīvāsa pradhāna
of the Lord devotees all Śrīvāsa the chief
tāṅhāra caraṇa-padme sahasra praṇāma
their at the lotus feet thousands of obeisances

38 Śrīvāsa is the chief of all the devotees of the Lord. I offer thousands of obeisances at their lotus feet.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrīvāsa — see Ādi 10.8.

*The Lord's avatāra (*īśāvatāra*) —*

অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য — প্রভুর অংশ-অবতার ।
তাঁর পাদপদ্মে কোটি প্রণতি আমার ॥ ৩৯ ॥

advaita ācārya — prabhura aṁśa-avatāra
Advaita Ācārya Lord Caitanya's partial avatāra
tāṅra pāda-padme koṭi praṇati āmāra
His at the lotus feet ten million obeisances my

39 Advaita Ācārya is a partial avatāra of the Lord. I offer ten million obeisances at His lotus feet.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Advaita — see Ādi, Chapter 6.

*The Lord's manifestation (*īśa-prakāśa*) —*

নিত্যানন্দরায় — প্রভুর স্বরূপপ্রকাশ ।
তাঁর পাদপদ্ম বন্দো য়াঁর মুঞি দাস ॥ ৪০ ॥

nityānanda-rāya — prabhura svarūpa-prakāśa
Nityānanda Rāya Lord Caitanya's manifestation of His own form
tāṅra pāda-padma vando yāṅra muñi dāsa
His lotus feet I worship whose I servant

40 Nityānanda Rāya is the manifestation of the Lord's own form (*svarūpa-prakāśa*). I worship the lotus feet of Him whose servant I am.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Nityānanda — see Ādi, Chapter 5.

*The Lord's potency (*īśa-śakti*) —*

গদাধর পণ্ডিতাদি — প্রভুর নিজশক্তি ।
তাঁ-সবার চরণে মোর সহস্র প্রণতি ॥ ৪১ ॥

gadādhara paṇḍitādi — prabhura nija-śakti
Gadādhara Paṇḍita and others Lord Caitanya's own potencies
tāṅ-sabāra caraṇe mora sahasra praṇati
their all at the feet my thousands of obeisances

41 Gadādhara Paṇḍita and the others are the Lord's own potencies. I offer thousands of obeisances at the feet of them all.

*The Lord Himself (*īśa-tattva*) —*

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য প্রভু স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ।
তাঁহার পদারবিন্দে অনন্ত প্রণাম ॥ ৪২ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu svayaṁ bhagavān
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya the Lord Himself Bhagavān
tāṅhāra padāravinde ananta praṇāma
His at the lotus feet endless obeisances

42 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu is the Supreme Lord Himself (*svayaṁ bhagavān*). I offer endless obeisances at His lotus feet.

সাবরণে প্রভুরে করিয়া নমস্কার ।
এই ছয় তেঁহো যৈছে — করিয়ে বিচার ॥ ৪৩ ॥

sāvaraṇe prabhure kariyā namaskāra
with His associates to the Lord having made obeisance
ei chaya teṅho yaiche — kariye vicāra
these six He how (is) I make consideration

43 Having offered obeisances to the Lord together with His associates, I shall now consider how He is present in these six.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Āvaraṇa, the surrounding retinue: the devotees who surround the Lord on every side are His *āvaraṇa*. I have bowed to Him together with this retinue. The six truths — the guru, the Lord's devotee, the Lord's avatāra, the Lord's manifestation, the Lord's potency, and the Lord Himself, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya — are His own *svarūpa*. Now I shall consider how this is so.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Gaurasundara receives endless obeisances, Śrī Advaita and the *śikṣā-gurus* millions, and the truths of potency and of the devotees thousands. This difference in the number of obeisances does not imply a worldly notion of difference born of *māyā*.

Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva displays Himself (*vilāsa*) in exactly these six forms of truth: the two gurus, the Lord's devotee, the Lord, the avatāra, the manifestation and the potency. By the principle of *acintya-bhedābheda*, this nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*) is called by the name “Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.”

যদ্যপি আমার গুরু — চৈতন্যের দাস ।
তথাপি জানিয়ে আমি তাঁহার প্রকাশ ॥ ৪৪ ॥

yadyapi āmāra guru — caitanyera dāsa
although my guru Caitanya's servant
tathāpi jāniye āmi tāṅhāra prakāśa
still know I His manifestation

44 Although my guru is a servant of Caitanya, I know him to be His manifestation.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

All *jīvas* are servants of Kṛṣṇa, so my guru too is in truth Kṛṣṇa's servant. Even so, I shall know my guru as Kṛṣṇa's manifestation (*prakāśa*). For the disciple, the guru is the very form of Kṛṣṇa's manifestation. But Nityānanda, who is Baladeva, is in truth *prakāśa-tattva* whose nature is *vilāsa*.

*The truth of the guru. (1) The *dīkṣā-guru* —*

গুরু কৃষ্ণরূপ হন শাস্ত্রের প্রমাণে ।
গুরুরূপে কৃষ্ণ কৃপা করেন ভক্তগণে ॥ ৪৫ ॥

guru kṛṣṇa-rūpa hana śāstrera pramāṇe
the guru Kṛṣṇa's form is of the scriptures by the evidence
guru-rūpe kṛṣṇa kṛpā karena bhakta-gaṇe
in the form of the guru Kṛṣṇa mercy shows to the devotees

45 The scriptures testify that the guru is a form of Kṛṣṇa. In the form of the guru, Kṛṣṇa shows mercy to His devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Everyone except Mahāprabhu Caitanyadeva is His servant. So in the guru no manifestation is possible other than service to Caitanya. He is a servant because he is the *āśraya-vigraha*, the form who shelters and holds love. The guru is a form in which service is manifest, and he appears in no other way than in service to the One who is served. The guru is the very form of a manifestation (*prakāśa*), and there is no room to regard him as the *viṣaya-vigraha*, the object of love. It is as the *āśraya-vigraha* that the scriptures call him a form of Kṛṣṇa.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.17.27)*

আচার্য্যং মাং বিজানীয়ান্নাবমন্যেত কর্হিচিৎ ।
ন মর্ত্ত্যবুদ্ধ্যাসূয়েত সর্ব্বদেবময়ো গুরুঃ ॥ ৪৬ ॥

ācāryaṁ māṁ vijānīyān
the ācārya as Me one should know
nāvamanyeta karhicit
should not disrespect ever
na martya-buddhyāsūyeta
not thinking him mortal should envy
sarva-deva-mayo guruḥ
comprising all the gods the guru

46 "One should know the ācārya as Me and never disrespect him. One should not envy him, thinking him an ordinary mortal, for the guru embodies all the gods." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.17.27)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān said to Uddhava: "O Uddhava, know the guru to be My very self. Do not regard the guru with *asūyā*, that is, with disrespect, thinking him an ordinary man. The guru embodies all the gods."

Anubhāṣya.
Uddhava heard about *svadharma*, one's true duty, both for those who follow *varṇāśrama* and for others; its defining mark is devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He then asked Bhagavān how to practise this devotion. The Lord describes the nature of each *varṇa*. Speaking of the *brahmacārī*'s life in the guru's house, He tells how one should behave toward the guru:

ācāryam (the guru) **mām** (as My dearest one) **vijānīyāt** (one should know) **karhicit** (ever) **na avamanyeta** (one should not reproach, even if there is a reason) **guruḥ sarva-deva-mayaḥ** ([for] the guru embodies all the gods) **martya-buddhyā** ([him] with an intellect bound by conditioned, material place, time and person) **na asūyeta** (one should not, growing envious through one's own material dullness, think him equal to oneself).

Ācārya: "The twice-born who performs the *upanayana* rite for a disciple and teaches him the Veda with its rituals and secret portions is called an ācārya." (*Manu-saṁhitā* 2.140). "He who gathers the meaning of the scriptures, establishes others in right conduct and himself acts accordingly is called an ācārya." (*Vāyu Purāṇa*).

Śrī Bhagavān Himself appears before the disciple in the form of the ācārya. In the conduct of the revered ācārya there is nothing but service to Hari. He is the

āśraya-vigraha in person. If someone has turned away from serving Hari yet fancies himself an ācārya, no one will take his bad conduct for good. The ācārya's undivided worship is what shows him to be a manifestation of Bhagavān. Those devoted to their senses and unsatisfied in enjoyment envy even the ācārya's faultless conduct. The ācārya is a limb inseparable from Bhagavān, the One who is served. Therefore a *jīva* who harbours hostility toward him loses the mercy of Bhagavān and His associates and falls into misfortune.

The guru is in truth a servant of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Yet the disciple looks with transcendental vision and will know him as a special manifestation of Śrī Gaurasundara. This does not mean that the guru in fact lacks the eternal relationship of a servant with Kṛṣṇa, the One he serves, or that he differs in no way from Vrajendranandana in the variety of *līlā*. The impersonalists (*nirviśeṣa-vādīs*) hold that transcendental realization contains no distinctions — neither internal ones, nor those among things of one kind, nor those among things of different kinds. But no Vaiṣṇava ācārya endowed with devotion follows their view or says that there is no difference whatever between the guru and Kṛṣṇa. He teaches *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*. Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu says of the guru: “Remember the best of gurus as most dear to Mukunda.” Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu wrote in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 213): “Pure devotees see Śrī Guru and Śrī Śiva as non-different from Bhagavān only in the sense that they are supremely dear to Him.” Following him, Śrī Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura said in his hymn to Śrī Gurudeva: “All the scriptures call him Hari Himself, and the virtuous regard him so; yet he is the Lord's dear servant. I worship the lotus feet of such a guru.” That is, all the scriptures say that for the disciple the guru is “Hari,” and the sādhus know the guru as such. But the guru, eternally the very form of a manifestation, has the right to the dear service of Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva. I, the guru's eternal servant, worship the lotus feet of such a guru. Every Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava meditates on the guru, knowing Śrī Gurudeva, the *āśraya-vigraha*, as *tadīya*, “His own.” In all the ancient systems of worship and in the songs of pure devotion, Śrī Gurudeva is named a dear friend of Śrī Rādhā or a manifestation of Śrī Nityānanda's own form.

*(2) The truth of the *śikṣā-guru*; his two forms: (a) the *caitya-guru* (the*

*guru within the heart), (b) the *mahānta-guru* —*

শিক্ষাগুরুকে ত' জানি কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
অন্তর্য্যামী, ভক্তশ্রেষ্ঠ — এই দুই রূপ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

śikṣā-guruke ta' jāni kṛṣṇera svarūpa
the instructing guru indeed I know Kṛṣṇa's own form
antaryāmī, bhakta-śreṣṭha — ei dui rūpa
the indwelling Lord the best of devotees these two forms

47 I know the instructing guru to be Kṛṣṇa's own form. He appears in two forms: as the indwelling Supersoul and as the best of devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

He who teaches worship (*bhajana*) is the *śikṣā-guru*. One who is without worship and of bad conduct is neither a guru nor an ācārya. Teachers are of two kinds: the *mahānta-guru*, who delights in worship, and the *caitya-guru*, who grants the discernment favourable to worship. Instruction in worship differs according to the goal (*sādhya*) and the practice. Śrī Gurudeva, who gives Kṛṣṇa, enriches the disciple with knowledge of *sambandha* and awakens in him a realization of his own service. The disciple receives the mercy of this *dīkṣā-guru* and learns to serve Viṣṇu properly. This instruction is called *abhidheya*. The *śikṣā-guru* is the *āśraya-vigraha* who embodies *abhidheya*. So he is not different from the *dīkṣā-guru*, who gives knowledge of *sambandha*. Both are Śrī Gurudeva. To treat one of them as higher and the other as lower, outwardly or at heart, brings offense. As words, Kṛṣṇa's "*rūpa*" (form) and "*svarūpa*" do not differ. The *dīkṣā-guru* Śrī Sanātana gives the lotus feet of Madana-mohana. The *jīva* has forgotten Bhagavān and cannot wander in Vraja. Sanātana gives him the realization that Bhagavān's feet are all his wealth. The *śikṣā-guru* Śrī Rūpa gives the right to serve the feet of Śrī Govinda and His dearest ones.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.29.6)*

নৈবোপয়ন্ত্যপচিতিং কবয়স্তবেশ
ব্রহ্মায়ুষাপি কৃতমৃদ্ধমুদঃ স্মরন্তঃ ।
যোঽন্তর্বহিস্তনুভৃতামশুভং বিধুন্ব-
ন্নাচার্য্য-চৈত্ত্যবপুষা স্বগতিং ব্যনক্তি ॥ ৪৮ ॥

naivopayanty apacitiṁ kavayas taveśa
not at all attain repayment the wise Your O Lord
brahmāyuṣāpi kṛtam ṛddha-mudaḥ smarantaḥ
even with Brahmā's lifespan (Your) deeds with growing joy remembering
yo 'ntar bahis tanu-bhṛtām aśubhaṁ vidhunvann
who within without of embodied beings misfortune dispelling
ācārya-caitya-vapuṣā sva-gatiṁ vyanakti
in the forms of the ācārya and the Supersoul the way to Yourself reveals

48 "O Lord, even with a lifespan as long as Brahmā's the wise cannot repay their debt to You, though they remember Your kindness with ever-growing joy. For You dispel the misfortune of embodied beings from within and from without, and in the forms of the ācārya and the Supersoul You reveal the way to Yourself." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.29.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Lord! The wise are filled with bliss when they remember You, yet even with a lifespan like Brahmā's they could not repay You. For in Your boundless mercy You abide outside as the ācārya and within as the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*). You do this to destroy all that is inauspicious in embodied souls and to reveal to them their own path.

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava had heard the scripture of yoga in detail and saw that the path of yoga is very difficult. He wishes to hear from Bhagavān briefly about *bhakti-yoga*, and he says to Him:

īśa (O Lord) **tava kṛtam** (the kindness You have done) **smarantaḥ** (thinking of it) **ṛddha-mudaḥ** (those whose supreme bliss has grown) **kavayaḥ** (the discerning) **brahmāyuṣā api** (even with a lifespan equal to Brahmā's, spent worshipping You) **apacitim** (repayment, that is, discharge of the debt) **naiva upayanti** (do not attain) **yaḥ** ([for] You) **bahiḥ ācārya-vapuṣā** (outwardly in the form of the ācārya, that is, as the *mantra-guru* or the *śikṣā-guru*) **antaḥ caitya-vapuṣā** (inwardly in the form of the indwelling Lord [*antaryāmī*]) **tanubhṛtām** (of embodied living beings) **aśubham** (what is inauspicious, that is, absorption in objects other than Kṛṣṇa) **vidhunvan** (dispelling) **sva-gatim** (their own path, that is, their true nature, marked by being the Lord's associate) **vyanakti** (You reveal).

*Śrī Bhagavān grants the perfection of love to the surrendered practitioner — (*Bhagavad-gītā* 10.10)*

তেষাং সততযুক্তানাং ভজতাং প্রীতিপূর্ব্বকম্ ।
দদামি বুদ্ধিযোগং তং যেন মামুপয়ান্তি তে ॥ ৪৯ ॥

teṣāṁ satata-yuktānāṁ
to them constantly united (with Me)
bhajatāṁ prīti-pūrvakam
who worship (Me) with love
dadāmi buddhi-yogaṁ taṁ
I give the yoga of understanding that
yena mām upayānti te
by which to Me come they

49 "To those who are always united with Me and worship Me with love, I give the understanding by which they come to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā 10.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"To those who worship Me with love through eternal *bhakti-yoga*, I give the pure *prema-yoga* born of pure knowledge. Through it they reach My abode of supreme bliss."

Anubhāṣya.

There are wise devotees (*paṇḍitas*) who know that everything arises and acts from Bhagavān. They are fixed in unwavering *bhakti-yoga* and worship Him; their minds are turned to Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa is their life. They share their feelings with one another and speak about Hari; so they please Kṛṣṇa and delight in Him. Of them Kṛṣṇa says to Arjuna:

teṣām satata-yuktānām (of those who always long to be joined with Me in service) **prīti-pūrvakam** (with love, with reverence) **bhajatām** (who serve: those who have given up other desires, karma and jñāna and are devoted to serving Hari) **tam buddhi-yogam dadāmi** (I give that *buddhi-yoga*, that is, I Myself awaken it in the movements of their hearts) **yena te mām upayānti** (by which they attain Me).

(The sense: this *buddhi-yoga* cannot be gained by oneself or from anyone else; I alone can give it, and only they, such devotees, can receive it.)

যথা ভগবান্ ব্রহ্মণে স্বয়মুপদিশ্যানুভাবিতবান্ ॥ ৫০ ॥

yathā bhagavān brahmaṇe
as the Lord to Brahmā
svayam upadiśyānubhāvitavān
Himself having instructed made (him) realize

50 "Just as the Lord Himself instructed Brahmā and made him realize the truth."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān Himself made Brahmā realize this by instructing him as follows.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.30–35)*

জ্ঞানং পরমগুহ্যং মে যদ্বিজ্ঞান-সমন্বিতম্ ।
সরহস্যং তদঙ্গঞ্চ গৃহাণ গদিতং ময়া ॥ ৫১ ॥

jñānaṁ parama-guhyaṁ me
knowledge supremely confidential of Me
yad vijñāna-samanvitam
which with realization endowed
sa-rahasyaṁ tad-aṅgaṁ ca
with its mystery its auxiliary part and
gṛhāṇa gaditaṁ mayā
accept spoken by Me

51 "Accept from Me the most confidential knowledge of Myself, endowed with realization, together with its mystery and its auxiliary part, as I now speak it." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.9.31)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Out of mercy I am telling you My supreme secret knowledge, filled with realization (*vijñāna*), together with its mystery and its parts. Accept it.

Anubhāṣya.
Brahmā resolved to create and sank into deep thought. He heard a divine voice say "*Tapa*" (austerity), and he gave himself sincerely to austerity. Viṣṇu became pleased with him, and Brahmā beheld Vaikuṇṭha. There he was freed from pride

and began to inquire about the truth, and Bhagavān spoke six verses. See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Bhāgavatam*, pp. 577–629.

me (My, that is, Bhagavān's) **jñānam parama-guhyam** (knowledge that surpasses even knowledge of the impersonal Brahman and the like) **vijñāna-samanvitam** (joined with realization [*vijñāna*]. I give you not merely knowledge of My form, but knowledge joined with *vijñāna*, the realization of Kṛṣṇa and of all that belongs to Kṛṣṇa) **sa-rahasyam** (with its mystery. If there is anything secret in it, that comes too, namely *prema-bhakti*) **tad-aṅgam ca** (and with its limb: *sādhana-bhakti-yoga*, which consists of hearing and the rest and aids knowledge of *sambandha*) **mayā gaditam** (spoken by Me. You did not ask about these three, yet I speak of them out of mercy, and no one else has spoken of them) **sat gṛhāṇa** (accept).

যাবানহং যথাভাবো যদ্রূপগুণকর্ম্মকঃ ।
তথৈব তত্ত্ববিজ্ঞানমস্তু তে মদনুগ্রহাৎ ॥ ৫২ ॥

yāvān ahaṁ yathā-bhāvo
as great as I (am) of whatever nature
yad-rūpa-guṇa-karmakaḥ
of whatever form, qualities and deeds
tathaiva tattva-vijñānam
exactly so realization of the truth
astu te mad-anugrahāt
may there be your by My grace

52 "By My grace, may you realize in truth exactly how great I am, what My nature is, and what My form, qualities and deeds are." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.9.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By My mercy, realize the full truth of what My own nature (*svarūpa*) is, and what My characteristics, form, qualities and *līlās* are.

Anubhāṣya.

yāvān (of what size and shape. That is, what My form is like, its limbs joined in a particular harmony of fullness, slenderness, length, height and the rest, and what My measure is in My own nature) **aham yathā-bhāvaḥ** (what My being is, what

My characteristics are) **aham yad-rūpa-guṇa-karmakaḥ** (He who has these forms, qualities and deeds. The forms are the dark, the four-armed, the two-armed and the golden, the form of Kṛṣṇa, of Rāma, of Nṛsiṁha and others. The qualities are love for the devotees and others. The deeds are accepting Lakṣmī, lifting Govardhana and others) **tathaiva** (just so, in every respect) **tattva-vijñānam** (realization of their truth) **mad-anugrahāt** (by My mercy) **te** (to you) **astu** (may it be).

(As *sādhana-bhakti* and *prema-bhakti* grow in you, you will realize ever more of the sweetness of My form, qualities and *līlās*. So you will directly realize Me in the land of Vraja — Kṛṣṇa, supremely hard to attain, whose sweetness surpasses even My own form.) (This by itself refutes the view that the four verses point to the impersonal.)

অহমেবাসমেবাগ্রে নান্যৎ যৎ সদসৎপরম্ ।
পশ্চাদহং যদেতচ্চ যোঽবশিষ্যেত সোঽস্ম্যহম্ ॥ ৫৩ ॥

aham evāsam evāgre
I alone was indeed in the beginning
nānyat yat sad-asat-param
not anything else which effect, cause, or beyond them
paścād aham yad etac ca
afterwards I what this (creation) and
yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'smy aham
what remains that am I

53 "Before creation I alone existed; there was nothing else, neither effect nor cause, nor what lies beyond them. After creation I exist, and all this creation too is I. And what remains at the end, that am I." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.9.33)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Before this world was created, I alone existed. Nothing existed apart from Me — neither *sat* nor *asat*, nor even the indescribable Brahman without attributes (*nirviśeṣa*). After creation I exist as all this, and when creation dissolves, I alone shall remain."

Anubhāṣya.

aham (the word *aham* [“I”] denotes the speaker, the one who has form, not the impersonal Brahman, for that cannot be its object. If knowledge of the self [*ātmā*] were meant, then, as in *tat tvam asi* [“you are that”], it would have been proper to say *tvam eva asīḥ* [“you alone were”]. I am that most enchanting divine form [*śrī-vigraha*] who now appears before you) **eva agre** (before creation, even at the time of the great dissolution) **āsam** (I was) **anyat na** (nothing else was. So say the Śrutis: “Vāsudeva alone was, neither Brahmā nor Śaṅkara,” “Nārāyaṇa alone was, neither Brahmā nor Īśāna,” and so on. Vaikuṇṭha, His associates and the rest are His inseparable part, so the same word *aham* includes them, just as the phrase “the king is setting out” includes his retinue.[0]) **sad-asat-param** (beyond *sat* and *asat*. *Sat* is the effect, *asat* the cause) **yat** (that, that is, Brahman) **tat anyat na** (is not other than Me. Or else: at that time, since there was no variety in the cosmos, I was in the form of pure, attributeless spirit, and in Vaikuṇṭha in the form of Bhagavān with attributes) **paścāt** (and after creation) **aham** (I alone am: in Vaikuṇṭha as Bhagavān and other forms, in the worlds as the indwelling Lord and other forms) **yad etat** (this universe) **tat api aham eva asmi** (that too is only I, for the universe is not other than Me and is Mine by nature) **yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'ham eva asmi** ([and at dissolution] what remains is I).

(The sense: the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's eternal *līlās* is not limited by time and the like, and He is manifest at all times.)

ঋতেঽর্থং যৎ প্রতীয়েত ন প্রতীয়েত চাত্মনি ।
তদ্বিদ্যাদাত্মনো মায়াং যথাভাসো যথা তমঃ ॥ ৫৪ ॥

ṛte 'rtham yat pratīyeta
apart from the reality (Me) what may appear
na pratīyeta cātmani
does not appear and in the Self (Me)
tad vidyād ātmano māyām
that one should know My māyā
yathābhāso yathā tamaḥ
like a reflection like darkness

54 “Whatever appears apart from Me, the Reality, and whatever does not appear in Me, know that to be My māyā; it is like a reflection and like

darkness." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.9.34)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The previous verse established knowledge of the nature (*svarūpa*) of the Supreme Truth. But there is no realization (*vijñāna*) until that knowledge of the *svarūpa-tattva* is made firm by knowing the truth that is other than the *svarūpa*. The truth other than the *svarūpa-tattva* is called *māyā*. This verse sets out knowledge of the *māyā-tattva* in detail. The *svarūpa-tattva* is the *artha*, that is, the true reality. Whatever is perceived outside that truth, and whatever has no place in the perception of the *svarūpa-tattva* itself, should be known as a manifestation of *māyā* (*māyā-vaibhava*) belonging to the *ātma-tattva*. Since this is not easy to grasp, here are two particular examples. Think of the *svarūpa-tattva* as the sun. What is other than the sun is perceived in two forms: as *ābhāsa*, a reflection, and as *tamas*, darkness. The sun's reflection falls from water onto another place; this is called *ābhāsa*. The side where the sun's power is not seen is called *tamas*, that is, darkness. The spiritual world is the rays of Bhagavān's own form. The manifestation of *māyā* is an *ābhāsa* that rests on its likeness to that world; this is the example of *ābhāsa*. The darkness far removed from the spiritual truth (*cit-tattva*) is that same manifestation of *māyā*; this is the second example. The point is this: the *ātma-tattva* and the *māyā-tattva* stand in a twofold relation. First, whatever is manifest as a form other than the *ātma-svarūpa* is *māyā*. And the ignorance, the non-self far removed from the *ātma-svarūpa*, is also *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

artham (the highest reality) **mām ṛte** (without Me) **yat pratīyeta** (what is perceived. When I am perceived it is not perceived, so it is perceived only outside Me) **yac ca ātmani na pratīyeta** (and what is not perceived without resting on Me, that is, is not perceived by itself) **tat** (a thing with these marks) **ātmanaḥ** (of Me, the Supreme Lord) **yathābhāsaḥ** (like *ābhāsa*, a reflection. *Ābhāsa* is a particular reflection of a luminary, somehow cast onto a place beyond its own light. It is perceived only outside the luminary, yet without the luminary it cannot be perceived at all) **yathā tamaḥ** (like darkness. Here the word *tamas* means a play of colours close to darkness. It does not exist in the light that is its source, yet it cannot exist without resting on that light) **māyām** (so too this potency called *māyā*, which is twofold: *jīva-māyā* and *guṇa-māyā*) **vidyāt** (one should know).

যথা মহান্তি ভূতানি ভূতেষূচ্চাবচেষ্বনু ৷
প্রবিষ্টান্যপ্রবিষ্টানি তথা তেষু ন তেষ্বহম্ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

yathā mahānti bhūtāni
as the great elements
bhūteṣūccāvaceṣv anu
in beings great and small after (creation)
praviṣṭāny apraviṣṭāni
have entered have not entered
tathā teṣu na teṣv aham
so in them not in them I

55 "As the great elements have entered all beings, great and small, and yet have not entered them, so I am within them and yet not within them." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.9.35)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The great elements enter beings large and small, yet they also remain independent, as if they had not entered. In the same way I, as the Supersoul (*Paramātmā*), the shelter of their existence, enter all beings in this world of elements, and yet I eternally abide apart in My form as Bhagavān. For the devotees I am the only object of love. The meaning is this. The great elements — earth, water, fire, air and ether — combine and manifest the gross world. They are present within it as its components, yet in their state as great elements they remain independent. In the same way the spiritual Supreme Lord creates the world through His material potency and His potency of the *jīvas*. With one portion of Himself He pervades the world, yet at the same time He eternally abides in His spiritual abode in the fullness of His spiritual form. And the *jīvas*, the tiniest particles of the rays of His spiritual form, taste pure love for Him on the path of pure love. This is the secret.

Anubhāṣya.

yathā mahānti bhūtāni (as the great elements, ether and the rest) **uccāvaceṣu bhūteṣu** (in higher and lower beings: gods, humans, animals and others) **apraviṣṭāni** (though situated outside) **anupraviṣṭāni** (appear to be within) **tathā** (so too [though I have not entered, for I abide in Vaikuṇṭha, beyond the worlds]) **aham teṣu** (I, in those renowned for the corresponding qualities) **nateṣu** (in those who

bow down to Me) **praviṣṭaḥ** (have entered: I abide in the heart to show Myself to their inner sight).

In the same way, without entering, I also abide outside. I do this to give their eyes My beauty and their nostrils My fragrance; to converse with them and fill their ears with the nectar of My sweet voice; and by touch, embrace and the like to let their bodies feel the tenderness, sweetness and other graces of My body. These devotees are beyond the *guṇas*, and I cannot leave them, either within or without: My play with them is always full of attachment. This shows that the "mystery" is their *prema-bhakti*, which brings Me so under their control.

এতাবদেব জিজ্ঞাস্যং তত্ত্বজিজ্ঞাসুনাত্মনঃ ।
অন্বয়-ব্যতিরেকাভ্যাং যৎ স্যাৎ সর্ব্বত্র সর্ব্বদা ॥ ৫৬ ॥

etāvad eva jijñāsyaṁ
this much only to be inquired into
tattva-jijñāsunātmanaḥ
by one who seeks the truth of the Supreme Self
anvaya-vyatirekābhyāṁ
by direct and indirect means
yat syāt sarvatra sarvadā
which is everywhere always

56 "One who seeks the truth of the Supreme Self should inquire into this alone, by direct and indirect means: that which exists everywhere and always." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.9.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One who seeks knowledge of the *ātma-tattva* should examine this subject by *anvaya-vyatireka*, the direct and the indirect method, and search for the reality that is eternal everywhere and always. The point is this: the means by which the secret of love is attained is called *sādhana-bhakti*. The seeker of truth learns *anvaya-vyatireka*, that is, injunctions and prohibitions, at the feet of a true guru. Cultivating the truth constantly in this way, he will attain knowledge of the truth.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* contains the teaching of Mahāprabhu Śrī Caitanyadeva in full. The *Bhāgavatam* has 18,000 verses.

The root of everything in those eighteen thousand verses lies in these four. The verse *aham eva* briefly describes the truth of Bhagavān, His own form, His qualities and His *līlās*. The verse *ṛte 'rtham* examines the truths of *māyā*, of the *jīva* and of matter. *Māyā-tattva* appears separately from Bhagavān's *svarūpa-tattva*. *Jīva-tattva*, through its connection with this *māyā-tattva*, is liable to fall under the control of the *māyā* potency. *Jaḍa-tattva*, matter, is the field of the *jīva*'s enjoyment. From these two verses one should fully grasp knowledge of *sambandha*. The verse *yathā mahānti* says that Bhagavān's eternal form abides separately, although the truth of Bhagavān is inconceivably one with the *jīvas* and matter and different from them. It also names the supreme goal (*prayojana*): the *jīvas* take shelter at His feet and gain the wealth of great love, *mahā-prema*. The verse *etāvad eva* names the only means to reach this supreme goal: *sādhana-bhakti*. *Sādhana-bhakti* includes injunctions that lead to the goal; as favourable, they are called *anvaya*. Actions that obstruct the goal and produce what is unfavourable are counted among the prohibitions and called *vyatireka*. The truth of practice is called *abhidheya*. *Abhidheya* is the instruction one receives through the direct meaning of the scriptures (*abhidhā-vṛtti*).

Anubhāṣya.

ātmanaḥ (of Me, Bhagavān) **tattva-jijñāsunā** (by one who wishes to realize what truly brings about his good) **etāvad eva jijñāsyam** (this alone should be learned at the feet of Śrī Guru).

(What is it?)

yat (that one reality which…) **anvaya-vyatirekābhyām** (through injunctions and prohibitions…) **sarvadā sarvatra syāt** (exists always and everywhere).

(If one asks which of heaven, liberation and *prema* is one's own good, the answer is: *prema* is established by its own *anvaya* and *vyatireka*, whereas heaven and liberation are not established by them.) (That is: of all that is to be learned, this alone should be learned. What is it?)

anvaya-vyatirekābhyām (through union and separation, that is, through *sambhoga* and *vipralambha*) **yat syāt sarvatra** (what exists everywhere: in Śrī Vṛndāvana and the other abodes beyond all the universes — in the servants, friends, elders and beloveds) **sarvadā** (eternally, even at the time of the great dissolution).

(This points to the relishing of the four *rasas* of servitude, friendship, parental love and amorous love: *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*.)

*(In the first verse of the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*) —*

চিন্তামণির্জয়তি সোমগিরির্গুরুর্মে
শিক্ষাগুরুশ্চ ভগবান্ শিখিপিঞ্ছমৌলিঃ ।
যৎপাদকল্পতরুপল্লবশেখরেষু
লীলাস্বয়ম্বররসং লভতে জয়শ্রীঃ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

cintāmaṇir jayati somagirir gurur me
Cintāmaṇi glory to Somagiri guru my
śikṣā-guruś ca bhagavān śikhi-piñcha-mauliḥ
instructing guru and the Lord whose crown is a peacock feather
yat-pāda-kalpataru-pallava-śekhareṣu
whose feet of the wish-fulfilling tree like the new leaves at the tips
līlā-svayaṁvara-rasaṁ labhate jayaśrīḥ
of play of choosing her beloved the rasa obtains Jayaśrī

57 “Glory to Cintāmaṇi, and glory to Somagiri, my guru! Glory to my instructing guru, the Lord whose crown bears a peacock feather. At the tips of His feet, which are like the tender leaves of a wish-fulfilling tree, Jayaśrī (Śrī Rādhā) relishes the *rasa* of choosing Him as Her beloved in play.” (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Glory to my guru named Somagiri, who is like a wish-fulfilling gem (*cintāmaṇi*)![0] Glory also to my *śikṣā-guru*, Bhagavān, who wears a peacock feather! Jayaśrī, that is, Śrīmatī Rādhikā, tastes the joy of *svayaṁvara*, the free choice of a husband: she is drawn by the beauty of His toenail tips, on feet that are like shoots of the wish-fulfilling tree.

Anubhāṣya.

The book *Śrī Vallabha-digvijaya* places the time of Śrī Bilvamaṅgala — a Draviḍian king of ascetics, a *tridaṇḍī* — in the eighth century of the Śaka era. Bilvamaṅgala is mentioned as the chief disciple of Rāja-Viṣṇusvāmī, who installed the Deity of Dvārakādhīśa. Bilvamaṅgala's disciples were Devamaṅgala and

others. Bilvamaṅgala worshipped for seven hundred years in Vṛndāvana at Brahma-kuṇḍa. After his meeting with Vallabha Bhaṭṭa, the worship of his Deity was entrusted to Hari Brahmacārī. Bilvamaṅgala's name also appears in the list of the Dvārakā *maṭha* of Śaṅkara's sampradāya: “Citsukhācārya (Kali era 2715), Bilvamaṅgala.” Līlāśuka Śrī Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura longed to enter the transcendental *līlās* of Vṛndāvana. At the beginning of his song *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta* he glorifies three kinds of guru:

me (my) **guruḥ** (the *śravaṇa-guru*, who shows the way) **cintāmaṇiḥ jayati** (Cintāmaṇi — may this guru be glorified) **somagiriḥ** ([the *mantra-guru*] Somagiri [may he be glorified]) **śikṣā-guruḥ śikhi-piñcha-mauliḥ** ([the *caitya*] *śikṣā-guru*, He whose crown ornament is a peacock feather) **bhagavān** (Vṛndāvana-candra [may He be glorified]) **yat-pāda-kalpa-taru-pallava-śekhareṣu** (at the toenail tips on His feet, which are shoots of the wish-fulfilling tree) **jaya-śrīḥ** (She who is both Jayā and Śrī, that is, Mahālakṣmī, the Queen of Vṛndāvana) **līlā-svayam-vara-rasam** (the sweetness, the joy, of a *svayaṁvara* [free choice] enacted in play, with deep *anurāga*) **labhate** (attains).

*Kṛṣṇa's mercy in the form of the *śikṣā-guru* —*

জীবে সাক্ষাৎ নাহি তাতে গুরু চৈত্যরূপে ।
শিক্ষাগুরু হয় কৃষ্ণ মহান্তস্বরূপে ॥ ৫৮ ॥

jīve sākṣāt nāhi tāte guru caitya-rūpe
to the soul directly (visible) not therefore the guru in the form of the Supersoul
śikṣā-guru haya kṛṣṇa mahānta-svarūpe
instructing guru is Kṛṣṇa in the form of a great devotee

58 As the guru within (*caitya-guru*), the Lord is not directly visible to the soul. Therefore Kṛṣṇa becomes the instructing guru in the form of a great devotee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The indwelling guru abides as the *caitya*, that is, within the mind. So one cannot see Him directly, face to face. That is why Kṛṣṇa becomes the *śikṣā-guru* in the form of the *mahānta*, the best of devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

The conditioned *jīva* cannot see Kṛṣṇa directly. Therefore Kṛṣṇa awakens in the *jīva*'s heart the discernment that leads to devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and so becomes the *caitya-śikṣā-guru*. And appearing as a *mahānta*, He becomes the *śikṣā-guru*.

*The need for the company of sādhus; the dharma, marks and nature of the sādhu-guru — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.26.26)*

ততো দুঃসঙ্গমুৎসৃজ্য সৎসু সজ্জেত বুদ্ধিমান্ ।
সন্ত এবাস্য ছিন্দন্তি মনোব্যাসঙ্গমুক্তিভিঃ ॥ ৫৯ ॥

tato duḥsaṅgam utsṛjya
therefore bad company giving up
satsu sajjeta buddhi-mān
with the saints should associate the intelligent
santa evāsya chindanti
the saints indeed his cut away
mano-vyāsaṅgam uktibhiḥ
the mind's attachment with their words

59 “Therefore an intelligent person should give up bad company and associate with saints. With their words the saints cut away the attachments of his mind.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.26.26)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Therefore an intelligent person will give up bad company and associate with sādhus. With their good instructions the sādhus will cut all the bonds of his desires that are unfavourable to devotion.

Anubhāṣya.

Urvaśī left Purūravā and went away. Beside himself with grief, he lamented for a whole year; then he gained discernment and understood the fruits of bad company. Śrī Bhagavān tells this story to Uddhava:

tataḥ duḥsaṅgam (bad company: the company of women and of those who keep company with women) **utsṛjya** (leaving far behind) **buddhimān** (one who discerns *sat* from *asat*) **satsu sajjeta** (should associate wholeheartedly with Hari's detached servants) **santaḥ** ([for] the sādhus) **asya** (of one absorbed in sense objects) **mano-vyāsaṅgam** (the mind's perverse attachment) **uktibhiḥ** (by their good instructions) **chindanti** (destroy).

*The fruit of hearing *hari-kathā* in the company of sādhus: the awakening of faith, *bhāva* and *prema* — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.25.25)*

সতাং প্রসঙ্গান্মম বীর্য্যসংবিদো
ভবন্তি হৃৎকর্ণরসায়নাঃ কথাঃ ৷
তজ্জোষণাদাশ্বপবর্গবর্ত্মনি
শ্রদ্ধা রতির্ভক্তিরনুক্রমিষ্যতি ॥ ৬০ ॥

satāṁ prasaṅgān mama vīrya-saṁvido
of the saints through association My power discussions
bhavanti hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ kathāḥ
become to heart and ear a delight the narrations
taj-joṣaṇād āśv apavarga-vartmani
by relishing them quickly on the path of liberation
śraddhā ratir bhaktir anukramiṣyati
faith rati devotion will follow in order

60 "In the association of saints, discussions of My power become narrations that delight the heart and the ear. By relishing them one quickly advances on the path of liberation: faith, *rati* and devotion follow one after another." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.25.25)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the company of sādhus, narratives that reveal My power are discussed, an elixir for the heart and ears. As a person listens to them, there soon awakens in him faith in Me, the path of liberation; then *rati*; and at last loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*).

Anubhāṣya.
Devahūti asked her son Kapiladeva what her highest good was, and Kapila replied:

satām (of Hari's servants) **prasaṅgāt** (through excellent association) **mama vīrya-saṁvidaḥ** (those in which My power is rightly understood) **hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ** (an elixir for the heart and ears: delightful to hearing and mind, giving happiness) **kathāḥ bhavanti** (narratives arise) **taj-joṣaṇāt** (by serving them) **apavarga-vartmani** (toward Hari, on the path to whom ignorance ceases) **śraddhā** ([first] faith) **ratiḥ** ([then] *bhāva*) **bhaktiḥ** ([then] *prema*) **āśu** (soon) **anukramiṣyati** (will come one after another).

(First comes faith, then the company of sādhus. Through that company one hears these narratives, and an inclination to serve arises — the activity of worship. Then, through excellent association, come narratives that remove the *anarthas*, the unwanted things in the heart. Next these same narratives produce steadiness (*niṣṭhā*) and so let one understand My greatness. Then they produce taste (*ruci*) and become an elixir for the heart and ears. By serving these narratives and relishing them with love, there will come one after another: faith in Bhagavān, which here means attachment (*āsakti*); *rati*, which is *bhāva*; and *bhakti*, which is *prema*.)

The truth about the Lord's devotees, and their kinds —

ঈশ্বরস্বরূপ ভক্ত তাঁর অধিষ্ঠান ।
ভক্তের হৃদয়ে কৃষ্ণের সতত বিশ্রাম ॥ ৬১ ॥

īśvara-svarūpa bhakta tāṅra adhiṣṭhāna
the Lord's own form the devotee His abode
bhaktera hṛdaye kṛṣṇera satata viśrāma
of the devotee in the heart Kṛṣṇa's constant resting place

61 The devotee is the very form of the Lord, for he is the Lord's abode. Kṛṣṇa always rests in the heart of His devotee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Whoever is devoted to the Lord (*Īśvara*) in His form of eternal being, knowledge and bliss — that is, his heart — is the place where Kṛṣṇa dwells.

Anubhāṣya.

The one and only nondual reality is the Lord (*Īśvara*). This reality, the Lord, possesses all potencies. By nature the devotee is of the same kind as His potency, not of the same kind as the possessor of potency. The inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa lives in the devotee who worships Him. Therefore Kṛṣṇa abides in the devotee as His support.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 9.4.68)*

সাধবো হৃদয়ং মহ্যং সাধূনাং হৃদয়ন্ত্বহম্ ।
মদন্যত্তে ন জানন্তি নাহং তেভ্যো মনাগপি ॥ ৬২ ॥

sādhavo hṛdayaṁ mahyaṁ
the saints the heart My
sādhūnāṁ hṛdayaṁ tv aham
of the saints the heart indeed I
mad-anyat te na jānanti
other than Me they do not know
nāhaṁ tebhyo manāg api
not I besides them even slightly

62 "The saints are My heart, and I am the heart of the saints. They know nothing but Me, and I know nothing but them, not even a little." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 9.4.68)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The sādhus are My heart, and I am the heart of the sādhus. They know no one but Me, and I regard no one but them as My own.

Anubhāṣya.

The sage Durvāsā offended the feet of the great devotee Mahārāja Ambarīṣa, and Viṣṇu's disc rushed forth to kill Durvāsā. He sought help from all the gods. At last Bhagavān Viṣṇu advised the sage Durvāsā to beg forgiveness at Ambarīṣa's lotus feet. In truth, with this verse He revealed the supreme greatness of the saintly devotees:

sādhavaḥ (the sādhus) **mahyam hṛdayam** (are My heart, as dear as My life) **sādhūnām tu aham hṛdayam** (and I am the heart of the sādhus) **te** (they, the sādhus) **mad-anyat** (anything other than Me) **na jānanti** (do not know) **aham** (and I) **tebhyaḥ** (apart from them) **manāg api** (even slightly) **anyat na** ([know] nothing else).

(The devotees always think of Me alone with all their being. And I always meditate on the devotees, who are wholly devoted to serving Me and have taken shelter at My feet with all their being.)

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.13.10)*

ভবদ্বিধা ভাগবতাস্তীর্থভূতাঃ স্বয়ং প্রভো ।
তীর্থীকুর্ব্বন্তি তীর্থানি স্বান্তঃস্থেন গদাভৃতা ॥ ৬৩ ॥

bhavad-vidhā bhāgavatās
like you devotees
tīrtha-bhūtāḥ svayaṁ prabho
holy places yourselves O lord
tīrthī-kurvanti tīrthāni
make holy the holy places
svāntaḥ-sthena gadā-bhṛtā
dwelling in their hearts by the bearer of the club

63 "My lord, devotees like you are themselves holy places. Through the Lord who holds the club and dwells in their hearts, they make even the holy places holy." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.13.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Devotees (*bhāgavatas*) like you are themselves holy places. The holy places are stained by the sins of sinners, and such devotees purify them by the holiness of Bhagavān, who dwells within them.

Anubhāṣya.
Vidura Mahāśaya had wandered through many holy places and returned to Hastināpura. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira greeted him with this verse:

prabho (O lord) **bhavad-vidhāḥ** (those like you) **bhāgavatāḥ** (devotees, sādhus) **tīrtha-bhūtāḥ** (are themselves holy places) **svāntaḥ-sthena** (by Him who dwells within them) **gadābhṛtā** (by Bhagavān Viṣṇu) **tīrthāni** (the holy places, which through contact with impure people have ceased to be holy) **tīrthī-kurvanti** (make into great holy places again).

(And your pilgrimage is the good fortune of the holy places themselves.)

সেই ভক্তগণ হয় দ্বিবিধ প্রকার।
পারিষদগণ এক, সাধকগণ আর ॥ ৬৪ ॥

sei bhakta-gaṇa haya dvi-vidha prakāra
these devotees are two kinds
pāriṣad-gaṇa eka, sādhaka-gaṇa āra
eternal associates one practitioners the other

64 These devotees are of two kinds: the Lord's eternal associates and the practitioners (*sādhakas*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Devotees are of two kinds: Bhagavān's associates and practitioners (*sādhakas*). Bhagavān's associates are the circle of perfected servants (*siddha-sevakas*). Some of them are devoted to His majesty (*aiśvarya*) and dwell in the spiritual sky, Paravyoma. Others are devoted to His sweetness, *mādhurya*, and are absorbed in serving Kṛṣṇa in Śrī Vṛndāvana. The *sādhakas* are those who follow *vaidhī* or *rāgānugā sādhana-bhakti* in order to attain perfection in service.

The kinds of the Lord's avatāras —

ঈশ্বরের অবতার এ-তিন প্রকার ।
অংশ-অবতার, আর গুণ-অবতার ॥ ৬৫ ॥

শক্ত্যাবেশ-অবতার — তৃতীয় এমত ।
অংশ-অবতার — পুরুষ-মৎস্যাদিক যত ॥ ৬৬ ॥

īśvarera avatāra e-tina prakāra
the Lord's avatāras these three kinds
aṁśa-avatāra, āra guṇa-avatāra
partial avatāras and guṇa-avatāras
śaktyāveśa-avatāra — tṛtīya e-mata
empowered avatāras the third thus
aṁśa-avatāra — puruṣa-matsyādika yata
partial avatāras the Puruṣas, Matsya and the rest all

65–66 The avatāras of the Lord are of three kinds: partial avatāras, guṇa-avatāras, who preside over the modes of nature, and, third, empowered avatāras (*śaktyāveśa*). The partial avatāras are the Puruṣas, Matsya and all the others.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *aṁśa-avatāras* are direct avatāras of Viṣṇu, masters of *māyā*. The *guṇa-avatāras* are avatāras of Bhagavān manifest in the three *guṇas*: *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. The *śaktyāveśa-avatāras* are exalted *jīvas* whom a special potency of Kṛṣṇa enters.

ব্রহ্মা বিষ্ণু শিব — তিন গুণাবতারে গণি ।
শক্ত্যবেশ — সনকাদি, পৃথু, ব্যাসমুনি ॥ ৬৭ ॥

brahmā viṣṇu śiva — tina guṇāvatāre gaṇi
Brahmā Viṣṇu Śiva three as guṇa-avatāras I count
śakty-āveśa — sanakādi, pṛthu, vyāsa-muni
empowered Sanaka and the others Pṛthu the sage Vyāsa

67 I count Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva as the three guṇa-avatāras. The empowered avatāras are Sanaka and his brothers, Pṛthu and the sage Vyāsa.

Anubhāṣya.
Īśvarera, "of the Lord," means of Kṛṣṇa in His original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). See the first part of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, the section on the object of worship and on the avatāras, and also *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya-līlā, Chapter 20.

*The Lord's manifestations differ by *līlā* —*

দুইরূপে হয় ভগবানের প্রকাশ ।
একে ত' প্রকাশ হয়, আরে ত' বিলাস ॥ ৬৮ ॥

dui-rūpe haya bhagavānera prakāśa
in two forms is the Lord's manifestation
eke ta' prakāśa haya, āre ta' vilāsa
one indeed prakāśa is the other indeed vilāsa

68 The Lord manifests Himself in two ways: one is called *prakāśa* (manifestation), the other *vilāsa* (pastime form).

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavānera, "of Bhagavān": of His original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). See *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya-līlā, Chapter 20.

*The Lord's manifestation (*īśa-prakāśa*) —*

একই বিগ্রহ যদি হয় বহুরূপ ।
আকারে ত' ভেদ নাহি, একই স্বরূপ ॥ ৬৯ ॥

মহিষী-বিবাহে, যৈছে যৈছে কৈল রাস ।
ইহাকে কহিয়ে কৃষ্ণের মুখ্য ‘প্রকাশ’ ॥ ৭০ ॥

eka-i vigraha yadi haya bahu-rūpa
one and the same form if becomes many forms
ākāre ta' bheda nāhi, eka-i svarūpa
in appearance indeed difference none one and the same identity
mahiṣī-vivāhe, yaiche yaiche kaila rāsa
in marrying the queens as as He performed the rāsa dance
ihāke kahiye kṛṣṇera mukhya 'prakāśa'
this is called Kṛṣṇa's principal prakāśa

69–70 When one and the same form appears as many, without any difference in appearance and with a single identity, this is called Kṛṣṇa's principal prakāśa. So He appeared when He married the queens and when He performed the rāsa dance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān manifests in two ways: as *prakāśa* and as *vilāsa*. Kṛṣṇa displayed many forms at once when He married the queens in Dvārakā and when He danced the *rāsa* in Vṛndāvana. Those forms did not differ in shape: one and the same form (*vigraha*) became many. This is Kṛṣṇa's principal *prakāśa*. But where the *svarūpa* takes another shape, one resembling itself, that manifestation is called *vilāsa*. Baladeva in Vṛndāvana, and Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva, Pradyumna, Saṅkarṣaṇa and others in Paravyoma, are *vilāsa* forms in which Bhagavān's own form appears.

Anubhāṣya.
"A *prakāśa* is not counted among the distinct forms, for He is not separate from Him." (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, first part).

Anubhāṣya.
"As one body became many forms in the *rāsa* dance, so at His marriage to the queens He appeared in many forms. This is known in the scriptures as *prābhava-vilāsa*."[0] (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 20.168).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.69.2)*

চিত্রং বতৈতদেকেন বপুষা যুগপৎ পৃথক্ ।
গৃহেষু দ্ব্যষ্টসাহস্রং স্ত্রিয় এক উদাবহৎ ॥ ৭১ ॥

citraṁ bataitad ekena
wonderful indeed this with one
vapuṣā yugapat pṛthak
body simultaneously separately
gṛheṣu dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasraṁ
in the palaces twice eight thousand
striya eka udāvahat
women He alone married

71 "How wonderful it is that with one body the Lord alone married sixteen thousand women at the same time, each separately in her own palace!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.69.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
What is wonderful is this: the one Kṛṣṇa, each time in a single form, married sixteen thousand wives at once in separate palaces.

Anubhāṣya.
bata (oh!) **etat citram** (this is wonderful) **ekaḥ** (the one Kṛṣṇa) **ekena vapuṣā** (in a single body) **yugapat pṛthag gṛheṣu** (at once in separate palaces) **dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasram** (sixteen thousand) **striyaḥ** (queens) **udāvahat** (married).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.3–5)*

রাসোৎসবঃ সংপ্রবৃত্তো গোপীমণ্ডলমণ্ডিতঃ ।
যোগেশ্বরেণ কৃষ্ণেন তাসাং মধ্যে দ্বয়োর্দ্বয়োঃ ॥ ৭২ ॥

rāsotsavaḥ sampravṛtto
the festival of the rāsa began
gopī-maṇḍala-maṇḍitaḥ
by the circle of gopīs adorned
yogeśvareṇa kṛṣṇena
by the master of yoga Kṛṣṇa
tāsāṁ madhye dvayor dvayoḥ
of them between each two (of two)

72 "The festival of the rāsa dance began, adorned by the circle of gopīs. Kṛṣṇa, the master of yoga, appeared between each two of them." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.33.3)

প্রবিষ্টেন গৃহীতানাং কণ্ঠে স্বনিকটং স্ত্রিয়ঃ ।
যং মন্যেরন্নভস্তাবদ্বিমানশতসঙ্কুলম্ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

দিবৌকসাং সদারাণামৌৎসুক্যাপহৃতাত্মনাম্ ।
ততো দুন্দুভয়ো নেদুর্নিপেতুঃ পুষ্পবৃষ্টয়ঃ ॥ ৭৪ ॥

praviṣṭena gṛhītānāṁ
by (Him) who had entered of those embraced
kaṇṭhe sva-nikaṭaṁ striyaḥ
around the neck beside herself the women
yaṁ manyeran nabhas tāvad
whom might think the sky then
vimāna-śata-saṅkulam
with hundreds of airships crowded
divaukasāṁ sa-dārāṇām
of the gods with their wives
autsukya-apahṛtātmanām
by eagerness whose minds were carried away
tato dundubhayo nedur
then kettledrums sounded
nipetuḥ puṣpa-vṛṣṭayaḥ
fell showers of flowers

73–74 “He entered between them and held each by the neck, so that every gopī thought He was beside her alone. Then the sky was crowded with hundreds of airships of the gods and their wives, whose minds were carried away by eagerness. Kettledrums sounded, and showers of flowers fell.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.33.3–4)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the master of mystic power (*yogeśvara*), by His inconceivable potency manifested a form of Himself between every two gopīs. Adorned by the circle of gopīs, He began the festival of the *rāsa*. When He had entered among them in this way, the gopīs felt that Śrī Kṛṣṇa was embracing them, His arm about their necks. At that moment the gods and their wives appeared in the sky, having come eagerly on hundreds of chariots. Then kettledrums sounded and a rain of flowers began to fall.

Anubhāṣya.

tāsām (of them, standing in a circle) **dvayor dvayor madhye** (between each two) **praviṣṭena** (by Him who entered in a separate form) **yam** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa, whom) **sva-nikaṭam** (as being close to herself [that is, “He has embraced me alone”]) **manyeran** (they thought) **yogeśvareṇa** (by that Kṛṣṇa) **kaṇṭhe gṛhītānām** (of those embraced at the neck from both sides) **gopī-maṇḍala-maṇḍitaḥ** (adorned by the circle of gopīs) **rāsotsavaḥ sampravṛttaḥ** (the festival of the *rāsa* began) **tāvat** (at that very moment) **atyautsukya-bhṛtātmanām** (of those whose minds were deeply stirred by longing to see) **sa-dārāṇām** (with their wives) **divaukasām** (of the gods) **vimāna-śata-saṅkulam** (full, filled, crowded with hundreds of aerial chariots) **abhavat** ([the sky] became) **tataḥ dundubhayo nedur nipetuḥ puṣpa-vṛṣṭayaḥ** (then kettledrums sounded and showers of flowers fell).

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, first part, 1.21)*

অনেকত্র প্রকটতা রূপস্যৈকস্য যৈকদা ।
সর্ব্বথা তৎস্বরূপৈব স প্রকাশ ইতীর্য্যতে ॥ ৭৫ ॥

anekatra prakaṭatā
in many places manifestation
rūpasyaikasya yaikadā
of a form of one which at one time
sarvathā tat-svarūpaiva
in every respect its very identity
sa prakāśa itīryate
that prakāśa is called

75 "When one form appears in many places at one time and is identical in every respect, it is called a prakāśa." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta 1.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When one form manifests at the same time as many identical forms, this is called *prakāśa*.

Anubhāṣya.
ekadā (at one time) **ekasya rūpasya** (of one form) **yā anekatra prakaṭatā** (the manifestation in many places) **sarvathā tat-svarūpaiva** (identical with it in nature in every way, that is, one in shape, qualities, *līlās* and the rest) **sa prakāśa itīryate** (is called *prakāśa*).

*The Lord's *vilāsa* (*īśa-vilāsa*) —*

একই বিগ্রহ যদি আকারে হয় আন ।
অনেক প্রকাশ হয়, 'বিলাস' তার নাম ॥ ৭৬ ॥

eka-i vigraha yadi ākāre haya āna
one and the same form but in appearance is different
aneka prakāśa haya, 'vilāsa' tāra nāma
many manifestations are vilāsa its name

76 But when one and the same form appears as many manifestations that differ in appearance, this is called vilāsa.

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, in the description of the *tad-ekātma-rūpa*, 1.15)*

স্বরূপমন্যাকারং যত্তস্য ভাতি বিলাসতঃ ৷
প্রায়েণাত্মসমং শক্ত্যা স বিলাসো নিগদ্যতে ॥ ৭৭ ॥

svarūpam anyākāraṁ yat
a form of different appearance which
tasya bhāti vilāsataḥ
His shines forth for pastimes
prāyeṇātma-samaṁ śaktyā
almost equal to Himself in power
sa vilāso nigadyate
that vilāsa is called

77 "When the Lord, for His pastimes, manifests a form of different appearance, almost equal to Himself in power, that form is called a vilāsa." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta 1.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When, in the play of His inconceivable potency, His own form appears in another shape, almost like Himself, it is called *vilāsa*.

Anubhāṣya.
tasya (of the original form) **yat svarūpam anyākāram** (a *svarūpa* different in shape, that is, with a different arrangement of the limbs) **vilāsataḥ** (through a particular *līlā*) **prāyeṇa** (less or greater in certain qualities) **ātma-samam** (like its own original form) **śaktyā bhāti** (appears by potency) **sa vilāso nigadyate** (is called *vilāsa*).

যৈছে বলদেব, পরব্যোমে নারায়ণ ৷
যৈছে বাসুদেব প্রদ্যুম্নাদি সঙ্কর্ষণ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

yaiche baladeva, paravyome nārāyaṇa
such as Baladeva in the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa
yaiche vāsudeva pradyumnādi saṅkarṣaṇa
such as Vāsudeva Pradyumna and the others Saṅkarṣaṇa

78 Examples are Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa in the spiritual sky, and Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and the others.

Anubhāṣya.
Baladeva is *svayaṁ-prakāśa*. Nārāyaṇa is *prābhava-vilāsa*.

*The Lord's potency (*īśa-śakti*) —*

ঈশ্বরের শক্তি হয় ত্রিবিধ প্রকার ।
এক লক্ষ্মীগণ, পুরে মহিষীগণ আর ॥ ৭৯ ॥

ব্রজে গোপীগণ আর সবাতে প্রধান ।
ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন যা'তে স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ॥ ৮০ ॥

īśvarera śakti haya trividha prakāra
the Lord's potencies are three kinds
eka lakṣmī-gaṇa, pure mahiṣī-gaṇa āra
one the Lakṣmīs in the city (Dvārakā) the queens another
vraje gopī-gaṇa āra sabāte pradhāna
in Vraja the gopīs and among all the foremost
vrajendra-nandana yā'te svayaṁ bhagavān
the son of the king of Vraja since Himself Bhagavān

79–80 The Lord's potencies are of three kinds: the goddesses of fortune (Lakṣmīs), the queens in Dvārakā, and the gopīs in Vraja. The gopīs are the foremost of all, for the son of the king of Vraja is the Supreme Lord Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Lakṣmīs dwell in Vaikuṇṭha, the queens in the city, that is, in Dvārakā, and the gopīs in Vraja are the third kind of potency. *Sabāte* means "among all." *Yāte* means "since": since Vrajendranandana, the son of the king of Vraja, is Bhagavān Himself. His companions in Vraja are His very own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
From *yadyapi āmāra guru* ("although my guru," verse 44) to *sādhaka-gaṇa āra* ("and the others are practitioners," verse 64): the examination of two truths, the guru and the devotee. From *īśvarera avatāra* ("the Lord's avatāras," verse 65) to

pṛthu vyāsa muni (“Pṛthu and the sage Vyāsa,” verse 67): the examination of the Lord and His avatāras. From *dui-rūpe haya* (“is of two kinds,” verse 68) to *pradyumnādi-saṅkarṣaṇa* (“Pradyumna and the others, Saṅkarṣaṇa,” verse 78): the examination of His *prakāśa* and *vilāsa*. Then from *īśvarera śakti haya* (“the Lord's potencies are,” verse 79) to *svayaṁ bhagavān* (“Bhagavān Himself,” verse 80): the examination of His potencies.

স্বয়ংরূপ কৃষ্ণের কায়ব্যূহ — তাঁর সম ।
ভক্ত সহিতে হয় তাঁহার আবরণ ॥ ৮১ ॥

svayaṁ-rūpa kṛṣṇera kāya-vyūha — tāṅra sama
of the original form Kṛṣṇa's bodily expansions to Him equal
bhakta sahite haya tāṅhāra āvaraṇa
devotees together with are His entourage

81 These potencies are bodily expansions (*kāya-vyūha*) of Kṛṣṇa, the original form of the Lord, and they are equal to Him. Together with the devotees they form His entourage.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Svayaṁ-rūpa: the verses of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* on *tad-ekātma* and related forms show that the two-armed Kṛṣṇa alone is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*. His *kāya-vyūha* is equal to Him; *kāya-vyūha* means the expansion of His own body. The devotees who stand beside this form are His *āvaraṇa*. When we consider the *āvaraṇa* together with the truth it surrounds, the six truths named above prove to be one. This conclusion is established only by considering *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*.

ভক্ত আদি ক্রমে কৈল সবার বন্দন ।
এ-সবার বন্দন সর্ব্ব শুভের কারণ ॥ ৮২ ॥

bhakta ādi krame kaila sabāra vandana
devotees and the others in order I made of all worship
e-sabāra vandana sarva śubhera kāraṇa
of all these worship of all good the cause

82 Thus I have worshipped them all in order, beginning with the devotees. Worship of them all is the cause of every good fortune.

প্রথম শ্লোকে সামান্য মঙ্গলাচরণ ।
দ্বিতীয় শ্লোকেতে করি বিশেষ বন্দন ॥ ৮৩ ॥

prathama śloke sāmānya maṅgalācaraṇa
in the first verse general invocation
dvitīya ślokete kari viśeṣa vandana
in the second verse I make particular worship

83 The first verse is a general invocation. In the second verse I offer worship in particular.

Explanation of the second of the opening fourteen verses —

বন্দে শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যনিত্যানন্দৌ সহোদিতৌ ।
গৌড়োদয়ে পুষ্পবন্তৌ চিত্রৌ শন্দৌ তমোনুদৌ ॥ ৮৪ ॥

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
nityānandau sahoditau
(and) Nityānanda risen together
gauḍodaye puṣpavantau
on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa the sun and the moon
citrau śan-dau tamo-nudau
wondrous bestowing auspiciousness dispelling darkness

84 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda, who have risen together like the sun and the moon on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa. Wondrous and bestowing auspiciousness, They dispel the darkness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda. Like the sun and the moon, They have risen wondrously at the same time in the land of Gauḍa, which is like Udayācala, the mountain of sunrise. They bestow good fortune and dispel the darkness of the *jīvas*.

Anubhāṣya.

gauḍodaye (in the land of Gauḍa, which is the Udayācala, the mountain of sunrise) **sahoditau** (risen at the same time) **puṣpavantau** (the sun and the moon together; and therefore —) **citrau** (wondrous) **śan-dau** (bestowing good fortune) **tamo-nudau** (dispelling darkness) **śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nityānandau** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda) **aham vande** (I worship).

**Gauḍodaye puṣpavantau* —*

ব্রজে যে বিহরে পূর্ব্বে কৃষ্ণ-বলরাম ।
কোটীসূর্য্যচন্দ্র জিনি' দোঁহার নিজধাম ॥ ৮৫ ॥

সেই দুই জগতেরে হইয়ে সদয় ।
গৌড়দেশে পূর্ব্বশৈলে করিল উদয় ॥ ৮৬ ॥

vraje ye vihare pūrve kṛṣṇa-balarāma
in Vraja who sported formerly Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma
koṭī-sūrya-candra jini' doṅhāra nija-dhāma
ten million suns and moons surpassing of both own effulgence
sei dui jagatere haiye sadaya
those two to the world becoming merciful
gauḍadeśe pūrva-śaile karila udaya
in the land of Gauḍa on the eastern mountain made rising

85–86 Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma formerly sported in Vraja, and Their effulgence surpasses ten million suns and moons. Becoming merciful to the world, these two have risen on the eastern horizon of the land of Gauḍa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nija-dhāma: radiance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Pūrva-śaile, "on the eastern mountain": on the Udayācala that is Gauḍa, on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā.

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য আর প্রভু নিত্যানন্দ ।
যাঁহার প্রকাশে সর্ব্ব জগৎ আনন্দ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya āra prabhu nityānanda
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda
yāṅhāra prakāśe sarva jagat ānanda
whose by the appearance whole world joyful

87 They are Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda Prabhu, whose appearance has filled the whole world with joy.

An example of causeless mercy —

সূর্য্যচন্দ্র হরে যৈছে সব অন্ধকার ।
বস্তু প্রকাশিয়া করে ধর্ম্মের প্রচার ॥ ৮৮ ॥

এইমত দুই ভাই জীবের অজ্ঞান-
তমোনাশ করি' কৈল তত্ত্ববস্তু-দান ॥ ৮৯ ॥

sūrya-candra hare yaiche saba andhakāra
the sun and moon remove as all darkness
vastu prakāśiyā kare dharmera pracāra
things revealing make of dharma the spreading
ei mata dui bhāi jīvera ajñāna-
in this way two brothers of the souls of ignorance
tamo-nāśa kari' kaila tattva-vastu-dāna
of the darkness destruction having made made the gift of the Absolute Reality

88–89 The sun and moon remove all darkness, reveal things, and so allow dharma to spread. In the same way the two brothers have destroyed the darkness of the souls' ignorance and given them the Absolute Reality.

*The definition of *kaitava* (cheating) —*

অজ্ঞান-তমের নাম কহিয়ে 'কৈতব' ।
ধর্ম্ম-অর্থ-কাম-বাঞ্ছা এই সব ॥ ৯০ ॥

ajñāna-tamera nāma kahiye 'kaitava'
of ignorance of the darkness the name I call cheating
dharma-artha-kāma-vāñchā ei saba
the desire for dharma, wealth and pleasure this all

90 I call this darkness of ignorance “cheating” (*kaitava*). It is the whole range of desires for religious merit (*dharma*), wealth and pleasure.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.1.2)*

ধর্ম্মঃ প্রোজ্ঝিতকৈতবোঽত্র পরমো নির্ম্মৎসরাণাং সতাং
বেদ্যং বাস্তবমত্র বস্তু শিবদং তাপত্রয়োন্মূলনম্ ।
শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতে মহামুনিকৃতে কিংবাপরৈরীশ্বরঃ
সদ্যো হৃদ্যবরুধ্যতেঽত্র কৃতিভিঃ শুশ্রূষুভিস্তৎক্ষণাৎ ॥ ৯১ ॥

dharmaḥ projjhita-kaitavo ‘tra paramo nirmatsarāṇāṁ satāṁ
dharma from which cheating is cast out here supreme of the non-envious saints

vedyaṁ vāstavam atra vastu śiva-daṁ tāpa-trayonmūlanam
to be known real here the Reality bestowing good uprooting the threefold miseries

śrīmad-bhāgavate mahā-muni-kṛte kiṁ vā parair īśvaraḥ
in the beautiful Bhāgavatam composed by the great sage what then with others the Lord

sadyo hṛdy avarudhyate ‘tra kṛtibhiḥ śuśrūṣubhis tat-kṣaṇāt
at once in the heart is captured here by the fortunate who wish to hear instantly

91 “In this beautiful *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, composed by the great sage, the supreme dharma is set forth for saints free from envy, and every kind of cheating is cast out of it. Here the true Reality is to be known, which bestows the highest good and uproots the threefold miseries. What need is there of other scriptures? As soon as the fortunate wish to hear it, the Lord is captured in their hearts.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* was first composed by the great sage Śrī Nārāyaṇa in the form of four verses (*catuḥ-ślokī*). It sets forth the highest dharma for those free from envy, that is, kind to all beings. This dharma is free from cheating (*kaitava*), and that cheating includes *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and even *mokṣa*. It destroys the threefold miseries of the *jīva*, bestows good fortune and gives knowledge of the true reality. Those who wish to hear the *Bhāgavatam* can

hold the Lord captive in their hearts at will. What need, then, is there for any scripture other than the *Bhāgavatam*?

Anubhāṣya.

mahā-muni-kṛte (composed by the great sage Śrī Nārāyaṇa) **atra śrīmad-bhāgavate** (in this beautiful *Bhāgavata*) **projjhita-kaitavaḥ** (that from which cheating has been entirely cast out: so *pra-* and *ujjhita* are understood. The cheating is hypocrisy made up of *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* and marked by the pursuit of results. The mark of this dharma is service to Bhagavān alone) **satām** (of Hari's servants) **nirmatsarāṇām** (free from lust, anger, greed, delusion, pride and envy) **paramaḥ** (the highest, for its aim is to set aside the scriptures of karma and jñāna) **dharmaḥ** (dharma [is described]) **atra** (in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **tāpa-trayonmūlanam** (uprooting the sins that bring suffering from one's own body and mind, from other beings and from the forces of nature) **śivadam** (bestowing good fortune) **vāstavam** (eternal, supreme, nondual) **vastu vedyam** (the reality to be known) **atra** (in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **śuśrūṣubhiḥ** (by those who wish to hear) **kṛtibhiḥ** (by those endowed with pious merit) **hṛdi tat-kṣaṇāt** (in the heart at once) **sadyaḥ** (without any delay) **īśvaraḥ avarudhyate** (the Lord is held captive).

তার মধ্যে মোক্ষবাঞ্ছা কৈতব-প্রধান ।
যাহা হৈতে কৃষ্ণভক্তি হয় অন্তর্দ্ধান ॥ ৯২ ॥

tāra madhye mokṣa-vāñchā kaitava-pradhāna
them among the desire for liberation the chief cheating
yāhā haite kṛṣṇa-bhakti haya antardhāna
which from devotion to Kṛṣṇa becomes vanishing

92 Among these the desire for liberation is the chief cheating, for it makes devotion to Kṛṣṇa vanish.

Śrīdhara Svāmī's comment on this verse —

“প্র-শব্দেন মোক্ষাভিসন্ধিরপি নিরস্তঃ” ইতি ॥ ৯৩ ॥

“pra-śabdena mokṣābhisandhir api nirastaḥ” iti
by the prefix pra- the intention of liberation even is rejected thus

93 “By the prefix *pra-* even the intention to attain liberation is rejected.” (Śrīdhara Svāmī, Bhāvārtha-dīpikā 1.1.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Among these, the chief cheating is the desire for liberation (*mukti*). That is why Svāmipāda pointed out that the prefix *pra-* means freedom even from the cheating that consists in aiming at liberation.

কৃষ্ণভক্তির বাধক — যত শুভাশুভ কর্ম্ম ।
সেই এক জীবের অজ্ঞানতমো-ধর্ম্ম ॥ ৯৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhaktira bādhaka — yata śubhāśubha karma
of devotion to Kṛṣṇa the obstacle all auspicious and inauspicious action
sei eka jīvera ajñāna-tamo-dharma
that one of the soul of the darkness of ignorance the nature

94 All action, auspicious and inauspicious, is an obstacle to devotion to Kṛṣṇa. It too belongs to the soul’s darkness of ignorance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda, the two brothers, are like the sun and the moon. Rising, They destroy the darkness in the hearts of the *jīvas*. The meaning of these verses is this. The *jīva* is by nature a spiritual truth. The *jīva*'s own original nature (*svadharma*) is devotion to Kṛṣṇa and love for Kṛṣṇa. Pious action (*puṇya*), sinful action (*pāpa*) and the aim of liberation have entered the *jīva* in the guise of his own nature and filled him with the qualities of darkness (*tamo-dharma*). All teachings that establish karma and jñāna are *kaitava*, cheating, and therefore serve the qualities of darkness. Before Caitanya and Nityānanda rose, these qualities of darkness polluted the hearts of the *jīvas*. The two brothers rose, drove the darkness out of the cave of the *jīvas*' hearts and revealed the true reality (*vastu-tattva*).

The fruit of Nitāi and Gaura's mercy —

যাঁহার প্রসাদে এই তমো হয় নাশ ।
তমো নাশ করি’ করে তত্ত্বের প্রকাশ ॥ ৯৫ ॥

yāṅhāra prasāde ei tamo haya nāśa
whose by the mercy this darkness is destroyed
tamo nāśa kari' kare tattvera prakāśa
darkness destruction having made make of the truth revelation

95 By the mercy of these two brothers this darkness is destroyed. Having destroyed the darkness, They reveal the truth.

*What the true reality (*tattva-vastu*) is —*

তত্ত্ববস্তু — কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণভক্তি, প্রেমরূপ ।
নামসংকীর্ত্তন — সর্ব্ব আনন্দস্বরূপ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

tattva-vastu — kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa-bhakti, prema-rūpa
the Absolute Reality Kṛṣṇa devotion to Kṛṣṇa in the form of love
nāma-saṅkīrtana — sarva ānanda-svarūpa
the congregational chanting of the Name all bliss itself

96 The Absolute Reality is Kṛṣṇa, devotion to Kṛṣṇa in the form of love (*prema*), and the congregational chanting of the Holy Name. All of it is bliss itself.

How They surpass the sun and the moon —

সূর্য্য চন্দ্র বাহিরের তমঃ সে বিনাশে ।
বহির্ব্বস্তু ঘট পট আদি সে প্রকাশে ॥ ৯৭ ॥

sūrya candra bāhirera tamaḥ se vināśe
sun moon external darkness they destroy
bahir-vastu ghaṭa paṭa ādi se prakāśe
external objects pots cloth and so on they reveal

97 The sun and moon destroy external darkness and reveal external objects such as pots and cloth.

দুই ভাই হৃদয়ের ক্ষালি' অন্ধকার ।
দুই ভাগবত-সঙ্গে করান সাক্ষাৎকার ॥ ৯৮ ॥

dui bhāi hṛdayera kṣāli' andhakāra
two brothers of the heart washing away the darkness
dui bhāgavata-saṅge karāna sākṣātkāra
two bhāgavatas with cause meeting

98 But the two brothers wash away the darkness of the heart and bring one to meet the two bhāgavatas.

এক ভাগবত বড় — ভাগবতশাস্ত্র ।
আর ভাগবত — ভক্ত ভক্তি-রস-পাত্র ॥ ৯৯ ॥

eka bhāgavata baḍa — bhāgavata-śāstra
one bhāgavata great the Bhāgavata scripture
āra bhāgavata — bhakta bhakti-rasa-pātra
the other bhāgavata the devotee vessel of the rasa of devotion

99 One bhāgavata is the great scripture, the *Bhāgavatam*. The other bhāgavata is the devotee, a vessel of the *rasa* of devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The two *bhāgavatas*" are the scripture *Bhāgavatam* and the devotee *bhāgavata*, the vessel of the *rasa* of devotion. The brothers let the *jīvas* meet these two face to face, gave them the *rasa* of devotion, and were conquered by the *jīvas*' love.

দুই ভাগবত দ্বারা দিয়া ভক্তিরস ।
তাঁহার হৃদয়ে তাঁর প্রেমে হয় বশ ॥ ১০০ ॥

dui bhāgavata dvārā diyā bhakti-rasa
two bhāgavatas through giving the rasa of devotion
tāṅhāra hṛdaye tāṅra preme haya vaśa
his in the heart by his love is subdued

100 Through the two bhāgavatas They give the rasa of devotion. Then the Lord, dwelling in the devotee's heart, is subdued by his love.

Citrau —

এক অদ্ভুত — সমকালে দোঁহার প্রকাশ ।
আর অদ্ভুত — চিত্তগুহার তমঃ করে নাশ ॥ ১০১ ॥

eka adbhuta — sama-kāle doṅhāra prakāśa
one wonder at the same time of both the appearance
āra adbhuta — citta-guhāra tamaḥ kare nāśa
another wonder of the cave of the heart darkness make destruction

101 One wonder is that both appear at the same time. Another wonder is that They destroy the darkness in the cave of the heart.

এই চন্দ্র সূর্য্য দুই পরম সদয় ।
জগতের ভাগ্যে গৌড়ে করিল উদয় ॥ ১০২ ॥

ei candra sūrya dui parama sadaya
this moon sun two supremely merciful
jagatera bhāgye gauḍe karila udaya
of the world by the good fortune in Gauḍa made rising

102 This moon and this sun are supremely merciful. By the good fortune of the world They have risen in Gauḍa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Jagatera bhāgye, "for the good fortune of the world": the two brothers preached the dharma of love, and it will gradually spread throughout this world. This is the world's good fortune.

Gauḍe, "in Gauḍa": the kings of the Sena dynasty moved the throne of their empire to the region of Śrī Navadvīpa from the ancient city of Gauḍa in the Maldah district. That is why the region of Śrī Navadvīpa is called the land of Gauḍa. In this Gauḍa, on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā, Mahāprabhu was born. Nityānanda Prabhu came there and joined Him, and together They rose.

**Śan-dau* —*

সেই দুই প্রভুর করি চরণ বন্দন ।
যাঁহা হইতে বিঘ্ননাশ অভীষ্টপূরণ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

sei dui prabhura kari caraṇa vandana
those two Lords' I make feet worship
yāṅhā haite vighna-nāśa abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa
which from destruction of obstacles fulfilment of desires

103 I worship the feet of these two Lords. This destroys every obstacle and fulfils one's cherished desires.

এই দুই শ্লোকে কৈল মঙ্গল বন্দন ।
তৃতীয় শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন সর্ব্বজন ॥ ১০৪ ॥

ei dui śloke kaila maṅgala vandana
in these two verses I made auspicious worship
tṛtīya ślokera artha śuna sarva-jana
of the third verse the meaning listen all people

104 In these two verses I have offered auspicious worship. Now listen, everyone, to the meaning of the third verse.

বক্তব্য-বাহুল্য, গ্রন্থ-বিস্তারের ডরে ।
বিস্তারি' না বর্ণি সারার্থ কহি অল্পাক্ষরে ॥ ১০৫ ॥

vaktavya-bāhulya, grantha-vistārera ḍare
abundance of what is to be said of the book's expansion for fear
vistāri' nā varṇi sārārtha kahi alpākṣare
in detail not I describe the essential meaning I tell in few words

105 There is much to be said, but I fear the book would grow too long. So I do not describe it in detail; I tell the essential meaning in few words.

(A saying of the ancients in their own scriptures, established by immemorial

usage) —

'মিতঞ্চ সারঞ্চ বচো হি বাগ্মিতা' ইতি ॥ ১০৬ ॥

'mitañ ca sārañ ca vaco hi vāgmitā' iti
measured and essential and speech indeed eloquence thus

106 "Speech that is brief and essential is true eloquence."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Eloquence means speech of few words, full of substance.

Anubhāṣya.
mitam ca (free of idle talk, only to the point) **sāram ca** (pointing to the essence) **vacaḥ hi vāgmitā** (such speech is eloquence, the skill of speaking).

**Śan-dau* —*

শুনিলে খণ্ডিবে চিত্তের অজ্ঞানাদি দোষ ।
কৃষ্ণে গাঢ় প্রেম হবে, পাইবে সন্তোষ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

śunile khaṇḍibe cittera ajñānādi doṣa
on hearing will remove of the heart ignorance and other faults
kṛṣṇe gāḍha prema habe, pāibe santoṣa
for Kṛṣṇa deep love will be will find satisfaction

107 Hearing this removes ignorance and the other faults of the heart. One will gain deep love for Kṛṣṇa and find true satisfaction.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Instead of *kṛṣṇe gāḍha prema habe* ("there will be deep love for Kṛṣṇa"), a variant reading has *sarva-tattva jñāna haibe* ("there will be knowledge of all truths").

Thus ends the first chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

[0]: Our verse translation of 1.57 reads differently: it takes Cintāmaṇi and Somagiri as two different gurus, whereas for Bhaktivinoda *cintāmaṇi* is a simile for Somagiri. (The *Anubhāṣya* on this verse likewise distinguishes them: Cintāmaṇi showed the way, Somagiri was the initiating guru.)

Anubhāṣya.

The *Mahābhārata* (Udyoga-parva, Chapter 43, verse 16) names twelve kinds of faults, and the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* eighteen. The difficulty of knowing the *svarūpa*: (1) *ajñāna*, ignorance — the notion “I am the material body”; (2) *viparyāsa*, inversion — the conceit of being an enjoyer of matter; (3) *bheda*, division — absorption in a second thing; (4) fear, and taking on a distorted form; (5) grief. These five are ignorance.

The subject the book describes —

শ্রীচৈতন্য-নিত্যানন্দ-অদ্বৈত-মহত্ত্ব ।
তাঁর ভক্ত-ভক্তি-নাম-প্রেমরসতত্ত্ব ॥ ১০৮ ॥

ভিন্ন ভিন্ন লিখিয়াছি করিয়া বিচার ।
শুনিলে জানিবে সব বস্তুতত্ত্বসার ॥ ১০৯ ॥

śrī-caitanya-nityānanda-advaita-mahattva
of Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita the greatness
tāṅra bhakta-bhakti-nāma-prema-rasa-tattva
Their devotees, devotion, the Name, love, rasa the truth
bhinna bhinna likhiyāchi kariyā vicāra
separately separately I have written having made consideration
śunile jānibe saba vastu-tattva-sāra
on hearing will know all the essence of the truth of the Reality

108–109 After careful consideration I have written separately of the greatness of Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita, and of the truth of Their devotees, of devotion, of the Holy Name, of love and of rasa. By hearing this, one will know the whole essence of the truth of the Absolute Reality.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the first chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

[0]: The edition prints «রাজহংসৌ প্রজাতীতিবৎ», a typesetting error; read «রাজাহংসৌ প্রয়াতীতিবৎ» (“as [one says] ‘the king is setting out’,” meaning his retinue as well); compare the same example in Śrīdhara Svāmī's commentary on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.32. [0]: The quotation in the *Anubhāṣya* is made up of lines from CC Madhya 20.168, in a different order and with the reading *prābhava-vilāsa* (the VCD translation of that verse has *prābhava*).

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১১০ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
Caitanya-caritāmṛta tells Kṛṣṇadāsa

110 Ever hoping for the mercy of the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.